

Portfolio Olivia Abächerli

Olivia Abächerli is a visual artist: drawing is the core of her work, on flat surfaces, on walls, or as animation layered with video.

Her practice consists of 3 dimensions: drawing as a bodily thinking process, political research that is being drawn through, and the meta-questions of how we contextualize ourselves in relation to others and the world, and how we could deal with the outer mess and inner tensions.

Across her work, OA relates to the panorama: Wimmelbild-like mappings address the dizziness and overwhelm when facing the complexity of the interwoven crises of late capitalism.

Some of her bodies of work have thematized, for example: individual vs. systemic responsibility in the ecological crisis, political rifts within families, what comes after witnessing?, is democracy working?, the simultaneities and relationships of the everyday and the catastrophic, morally problematic entanglements of Swiss economic policy, Swiss colonial history, historical rural Commons, class and queerness, etc.

All parts of the crises relate to „us“

materially and affectively on endless chains of contingencies. How can we witness, track and map all those relations of power? After neoliberal fragmentation, an urgency for grasping the world in its totality and a desire for a new, different universality reappears.

OA works towards those desires across multiplicities of layered epistemologies, but integrating positionality: While using her own position – grown up queer in the Swiss' rurality – as an exemplary subjectivity, her work insists that one's own specific position in and perspective on the world (including blank spots, responsibilities, ideologies, etc.) can never be left behind and needs careful attention.

Drawing is aiming to grasp systems, patterns, ideas and relations. Core to OA's drawing is the use of iterations. With each repeated mark, drawing becomes a physical record of insisting, reevaluating and re-negotiating, in order to keep trying to understand. The iteration is key to her use of frames in animation, too: frames are used as choreographed series of drawings, and each frame is a new attempt.

SELECTED GROUP EXHIBITIONS

2026

- Le Commun, Geneva [Rivages \(shore\)](#)
- ARD art institution, Cairo [Latent, yet Operative](#)
- Kunst(zeug)haus Rapperswil [A Phantom with Limbs of Steel](#)

2025

- Messe Art Basel [Swiss Art Awards](#)
- Kunsthaus Langenthal [Im Haus der grossen Frau. Ein künstlerischer Blick auf die Sozialpionierin Amélie Moser-Moser](#)
- Picalilli Gallery, London [All Over The Place](#)

2024

- b-05, Montabaur, GER [ECHOHALL IM BUNKER: history invades the present](#)

2023

- Our Place, Taipei, TWN [Neutral background](#)
- Imaginary Z, Hangzhou, CHN [Light and cold conversation: Agency and Technology](#)
- CAN Centre d'art Neuchâtel [Video Show & The Blind Pigeon](#)

2022

- Nieuwe Vide & GOLF-festival, Haarlem, NL
Collaboration with Harun Morrison [Ataraxia](#)

2021

- E-Werk, Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, Freiburg, GER [Material Worlds – Storied Matter](#)
- Kunsthalle Basel [...von möglichen Welten](#)

2020

- Espace 3353, Le Carouge, Geneva [The Stones in our Hands](#)

SOLO PROJECTS

2025

- Hirscheneck, Basel [wing beat](#)
- Greenpeace UK headquarters, UK [How do you weigh a sigh?](#)

2024

- Kunsthalle Bern [the center and the other \(title in progress\)](#)

2023

- Projekt Links, Galerie DuflonRacz, Bern, Kollektiv «Companionship Euphoria» [You are not here with me in the kitchen right now, but I wish you were](#)
- Kunsthalle Luzern [the center and the other](#)

2022

- Espace libre, Biel/Bienne [global earth powder trace](#)

2021

- Ausstellungsraum Klingental, Basel, Kollektiv «DUELL» [Smudge, the messenger –](#)
- Galerie Hofmatt, Sarnen [IBU SILLA](#)

2020

- Benzeholz – Zeitgenössische Kunst, Meggen, Kollektiv «DUELL» [Riddley, how does one make fire again?](#)

2019

- M8 Art Space, Helsinki, FIN [I can't hear myself without you listening](#)

PUBLICATIONS

2025

- [Tools for collective being](#) (Book project with Égle Šalkauskyte, unvague, Bern)

2024

- [Ibu Silla](#) (Book project, Edition Fink, Zürich)

2023 – 2024

- [Jelly Sunday Zine](#) (Online Zine, monthly, curated by Égle Šalkauskyte)

2023

- [Ich bin frei und mir ist schlecht](#) (with Tanja Schwarz)

EDUCATION

2019–2021

- Fellowship [Sommerakademie Paul Klee](#) (Tirdad Zolghadr – STATECRAFT)

2017–2019

- MA Art Practice, [Dutch Art Institute](#), Arnhem, NL

2013–2016

- BA Fine Arts with distinction, Hochschule der Künste Bern

CURATORIAL PROJECTS & TEACHING

2024

- Hochschule der Künste Bern, Y-Institut, with Yvonne Lanz [How do I care if everything seems to fall apart?](#)

2023

- Hochschule der Künste Bern, Y-Institut, with Yvonne Lanz [Radical Empathy](#)

2021

- Hochschule der Künste Bern, BA Fine Arts, with Felipe Castelblanco and Airi Triisberg [Decolonial Sensibilities](#)
- Hochschule der Künste Bern, Y-Institut, with Yvonne Lanz [Future Cartographies](#)

2019

- Hochschule der Künste Bern, BA Fine Arts, with Felipe Castelblanco [Para-Fictioning](#)

2017–2021

- [Cabane B project space](#) (Organisation, curation)

2016–2019

- [Immer Am Achten Schwobhaus](#) (Organisation, curation)

2015 / 2017

- [Artist Residency Weidli](#) Residency programme with Remy Erismann (Organisation, curation)

Enclosure is a sibling of crime

Iterations

- «Enclosure is a sibling of crime», (video), 2026
- «Enclosure is a sibling of crime», (pencil on wall), «A Phantom with Limbs of Steel», Kunst(zeug)haus Rapperswil, 2026



«Enclosure is a sibling of crime»

2026

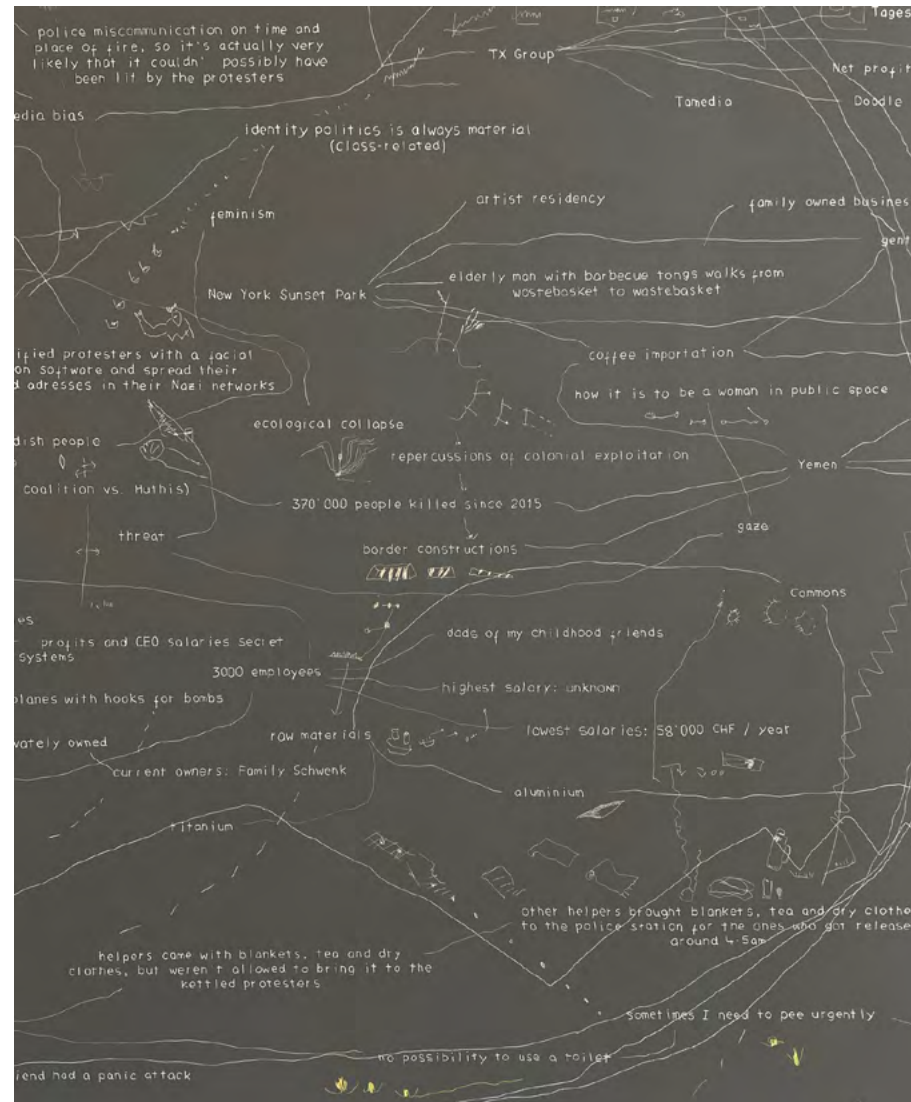
Full HD, stereo, loop

16:9 / 4:3, 7'51''

[Video link \(pCloud\)](#)

Starting from the Swiss weapon industry, the artist conducted an extensive research on the multifaceted violences of globalized economies and their repercussions on individual and collective social life. This video work is being shown accompanied by a text in a publication and/or a mural.

• Kunst(zeug)haus Rapperswil, «A Phantom with Limbs of Steel», 2026



«Enclosure is a sibling of crime»
 2026
 pencil on wall
 11 x 3,6 m

• Kunst(zeug)haus Rapperswil «A Phantom with Limbs of Steel», 2026



my mouth on a bridge (tools for learn- ing Arabic)

«my mouth on a bridge (tools
for learning Arabic)»
2026
Video
HD, stereo, loop, 16:9, 9'39''
[Video Link \(pCloud\)](#)

Can I see you without searching for
traces of myself in you, without project-
ing my own images onto you?

The muscles in our mouth are built
through our primary languages. The
associations we get from sounds are
shaped by everything we experienced
and heard.

This work proposes the use of our

embodied, individually shaped ways of
sensing and relating not as an obstacle
for understanding each other, but as a
potential tool.



↑ Film Still: «my mouth on a bridge (tools for learning Arabic)»

How bad is soap
bubble?

«How bad is soap bubble?»
2026
pencil on paper
series, ongoing

Is it the consumption of Seltzer water, of soap bubble, of a coffee, of a burger actually worth it?

This series of drawings is an excerpt from a research on ecological repercussions of 92 selected consumption objects (from tap water to a bomb). Starting from quantifiable factors like Co2 output, working hours, economic value or health metrics (QALYs), more

affective, tenseful and elusive considerations (like worth, pleasure, or abstract future death of people who don't exist yet) are tackled via the means of repetitive search-like drawing.



i'm loving it

«i'm loving it»

2026

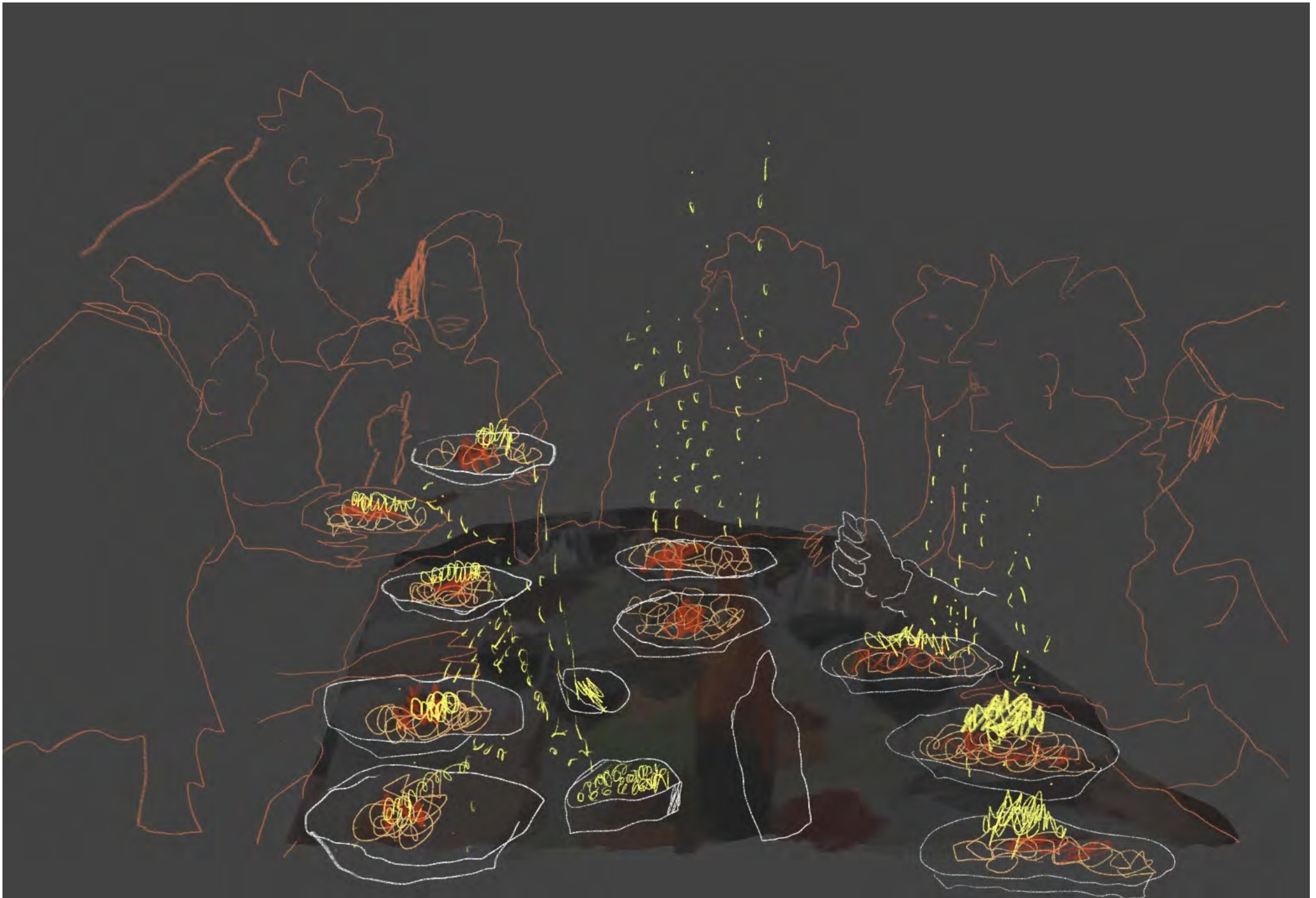
Video

HD, stereo, loop, 16:9, 12'03''

[Video Link \(pCloud\)](#)

How does identity clash with moral inclinations — and how to break free? Any consumption of animal-derived products cannot be reconciled with intersectional feminism and ecological awareness. In «i'm loving it», the artist — stemming from a farming family — maps her conflict: loving cows while sometimes still participating in their exploitation and killing, despite a decade of striv-

ing to live vegan. The cow's ambiguous liberation echoes her unresolved struggle to untangle violence from affection.



↑ Film Still: «i'm loving it»



how do you weigh a sigh?

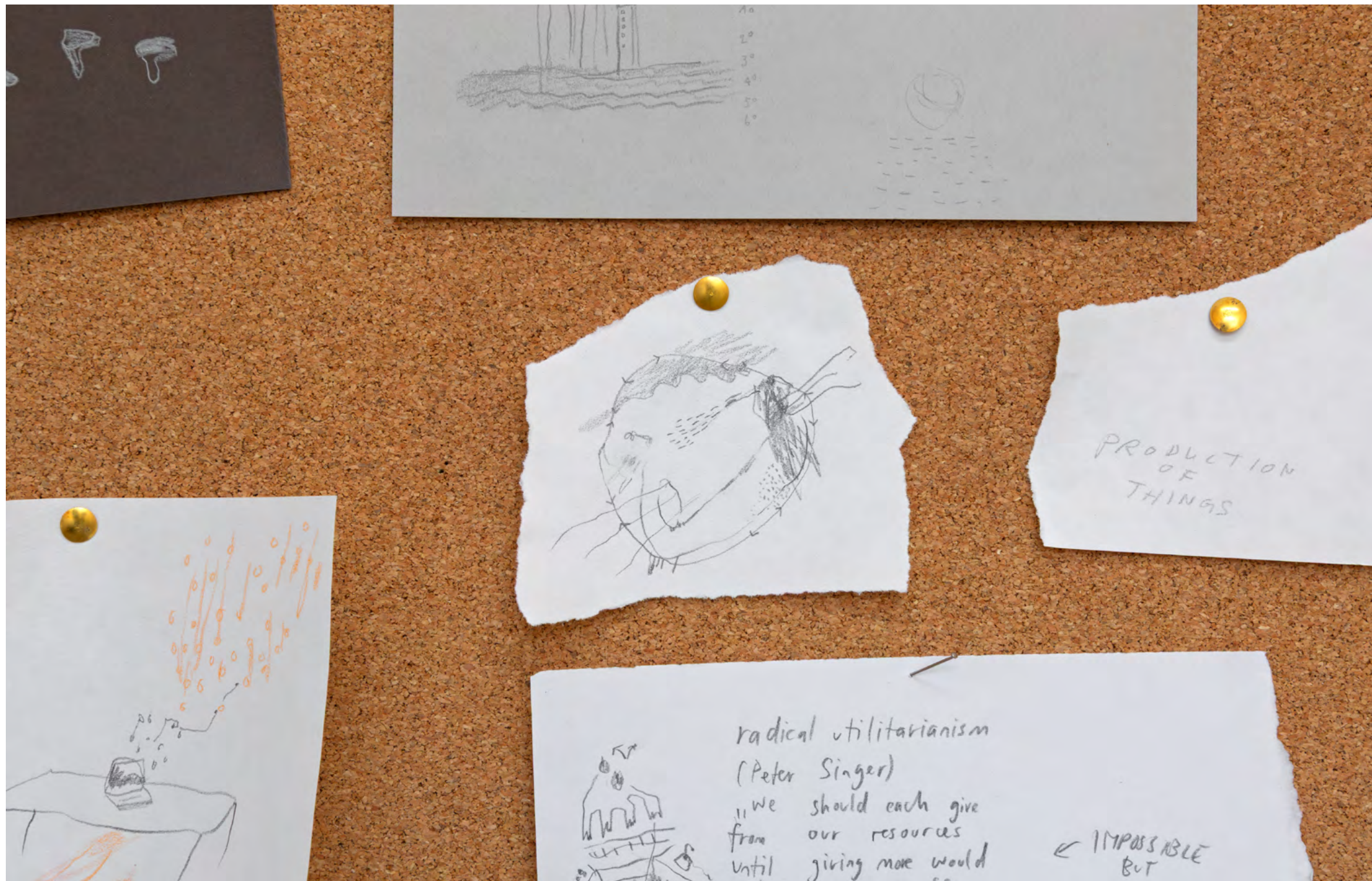
«how do you weigh a sigh?»
2025 - ongoing
Drawings on cork board, pins
120 x 120cm

- Greenpeace UK headquarters, London
- Picallilli Gallery, London

«How do you weigh a sigh?» features scores of informal notes and drawings. Olivia externalizes a series of inner conflicts, contradictions and emotional tensions arising from her own questioning of how to live amid political and climate crises. The work thematizes feelings of being overwhelmed and the desire to grasp the complexity of personal, scientific and political entanglements.

(Text: Harun Morrison)





Wing Beat

«Wing Beat»
2025 - ongoing
series of 96 drawings
pencil on paper
mostly 21 x 29,7cm

• Hirscheneck, Basel «wing beat» 2025

In «Wing Beat», sketches of potential animation frames are shown as a large series. At protests, within a culture of normalization of authoritarianism, violence is then framed as legitimate when performed by the state. By looking at movements frame-by-frame, the artists tries to develop a gaze that looks very closely. She tries to explore nuances of power by shifting between bird's-eye view and an intimate view from within.



To witness is the same
thing as to breathe (to do it
once is not enough)

Iterations

- «To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)», (video) 2025
- «To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)», (drawings on cardboard mount) 2025
- «weight of a day», (drawings on paper) 2022 - 2024



↑ Film still: «To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)»

«To witness is the same thing
as to breathe (to do it once
is not enough)»

2025

Full HD, stereo, loop

16:9, 15'20''

[Video link \(pCloud\)](#)

The animation shows discussions with
the artist's sister, who has different
political perspectives. They become
visually flickering, distorted, and co-
alesce with their environment. Another
scene depicts the movement of an
organized collective from the table to the
streets.

- Messe Art Basel «Swiss Art Awards», 2025
- Talmuseum Engelberg «Nächster Halt», 2025



↑ Film still: «To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)»



to take a stance on everything?

«To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)»

2025

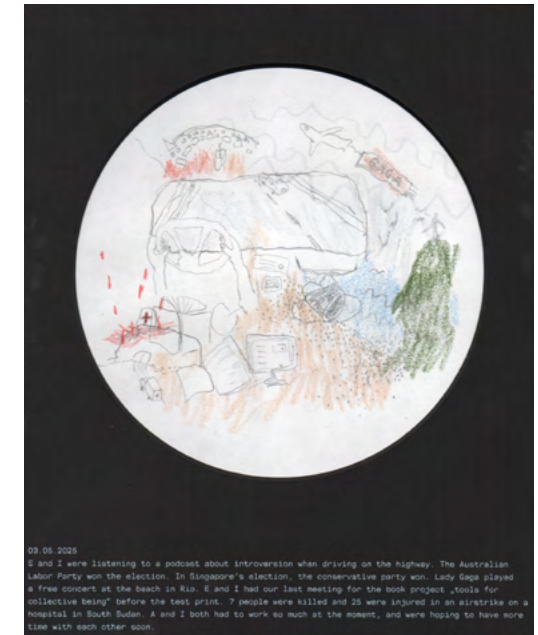
Pencil and color pencil on paper, UV flatbed print on archival board

23,1 x 18,7 cm

Series of 125 pieces

- Messe Art Basel «Swiss Art Awards», 2025
- Stadtgalerie Bern «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2025
- Le Commun, Geneva «Rivages», 2026

Through writing and drawing every day, the artist documents global events of de-democratization, imperial genocides, wars, and the climate crisis. She places her personal daily life in these texts and drawings, contextualized within that global situation but also often in harsh contrast to the horrors of those events.



«To witness is the same thing as to breathe (to do it once is not enough)»

2025

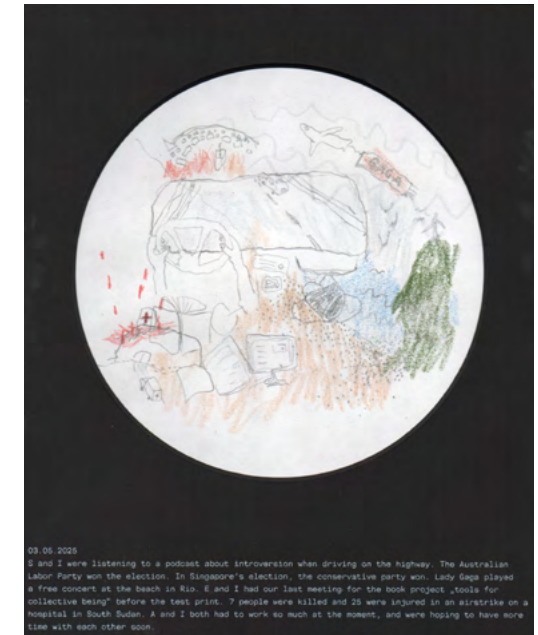
Pencil and color pencil on paper, UV flatbed print on archival board

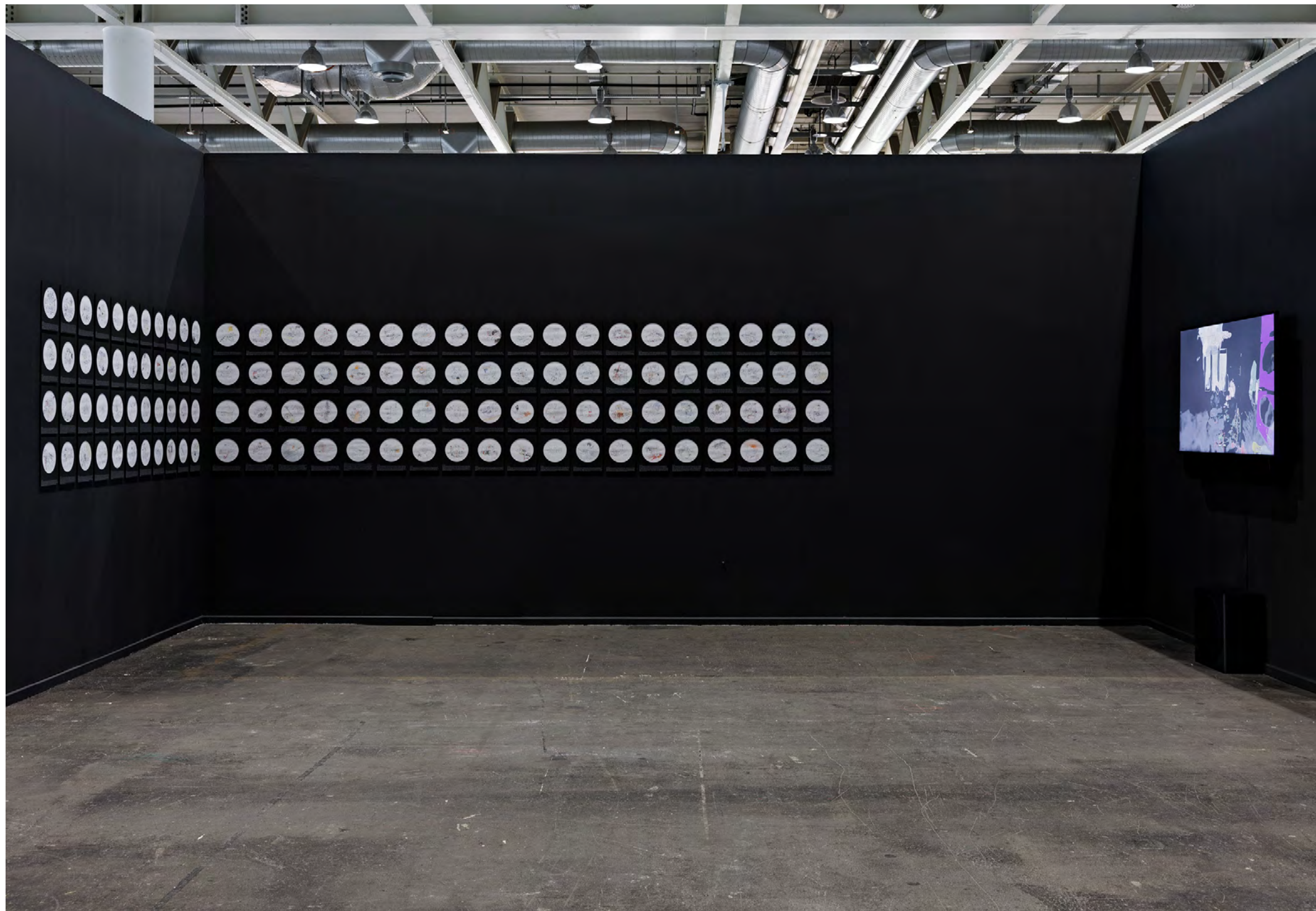
23,1 x 18,7 cm

Series of 125 pieces

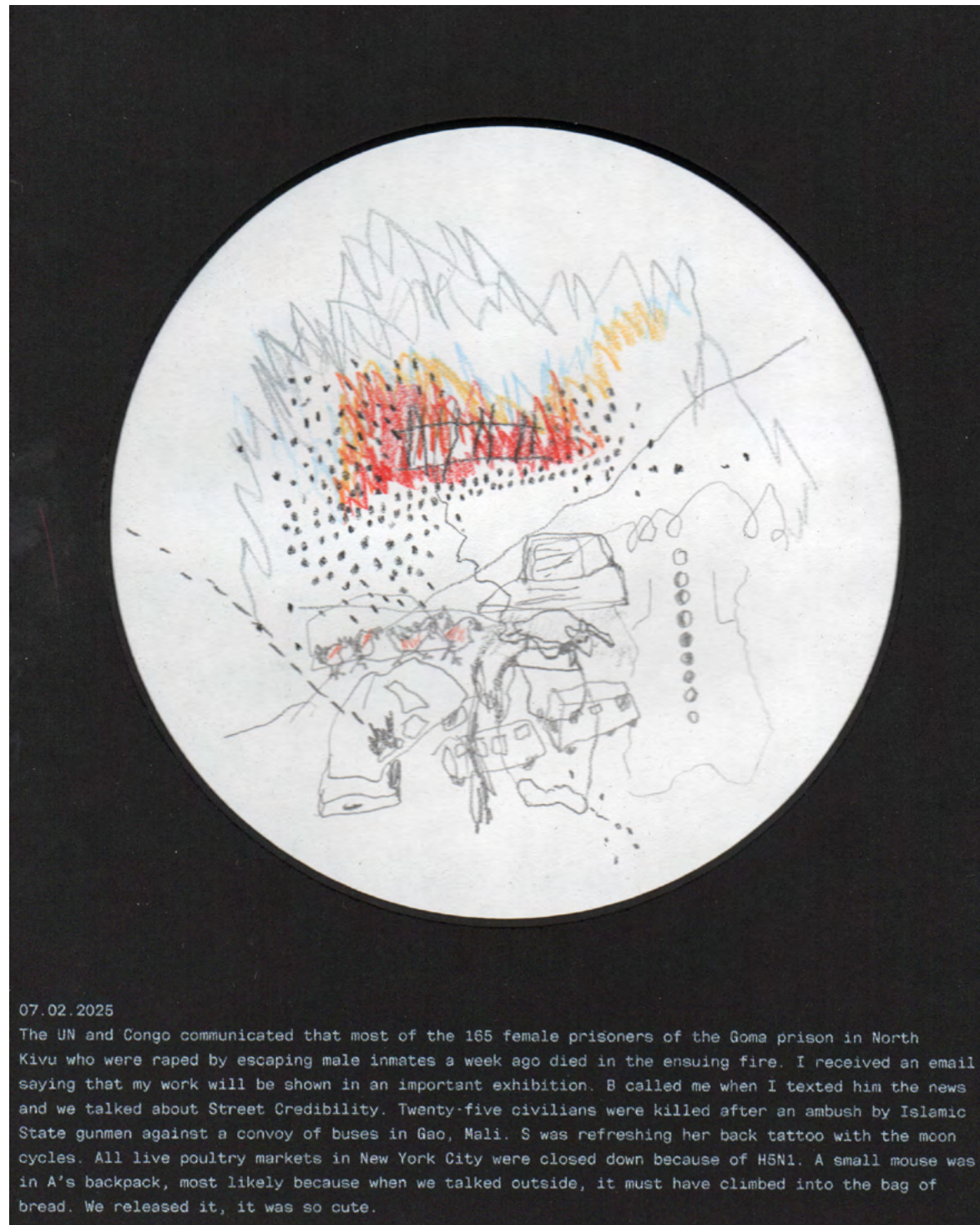
- Messe Art Basel «Swiss Art Awards», 2025
- Stadtgalerie Bern «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2025
- Le Commun, Geneva «Rivages», 2026

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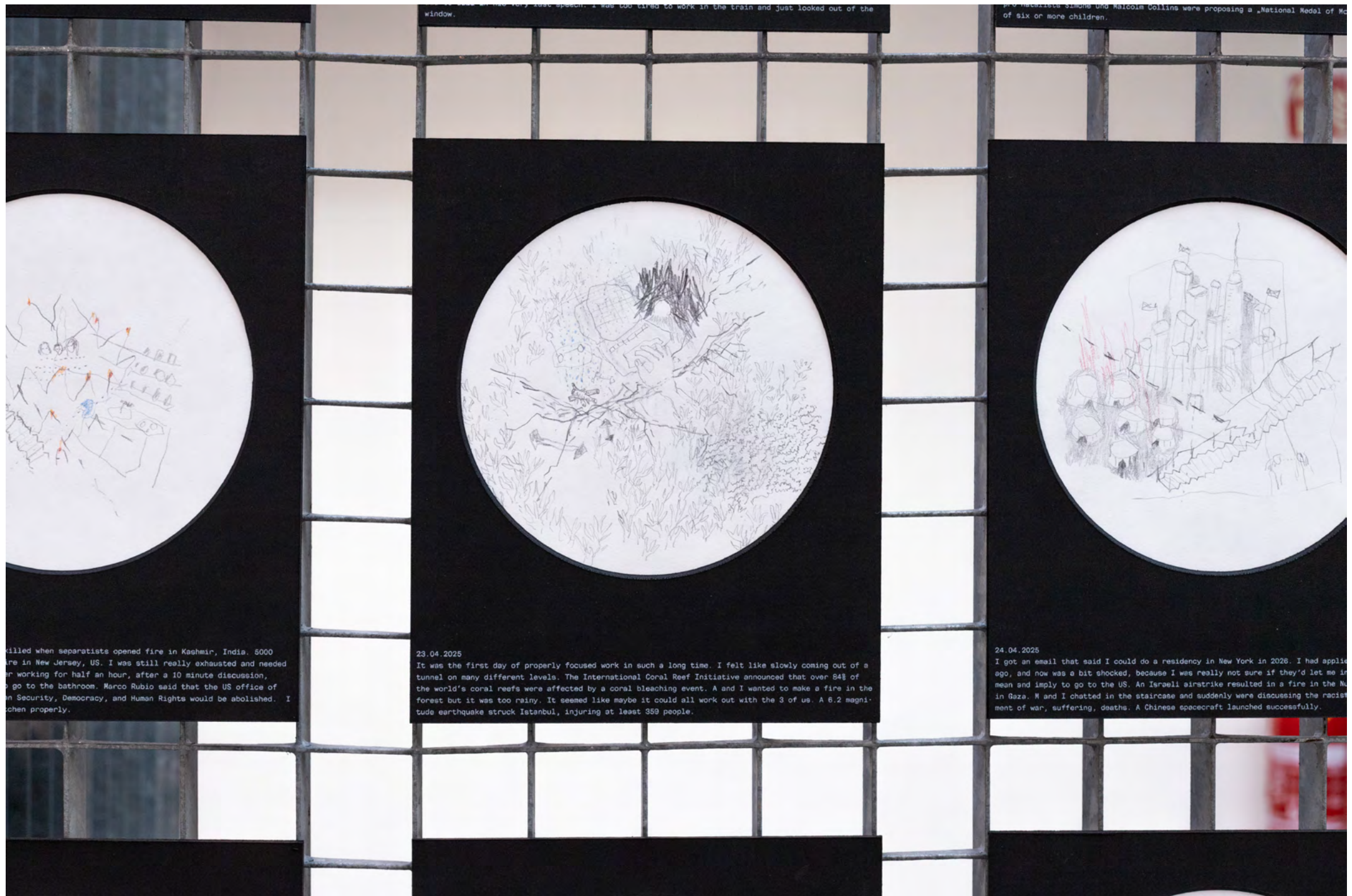


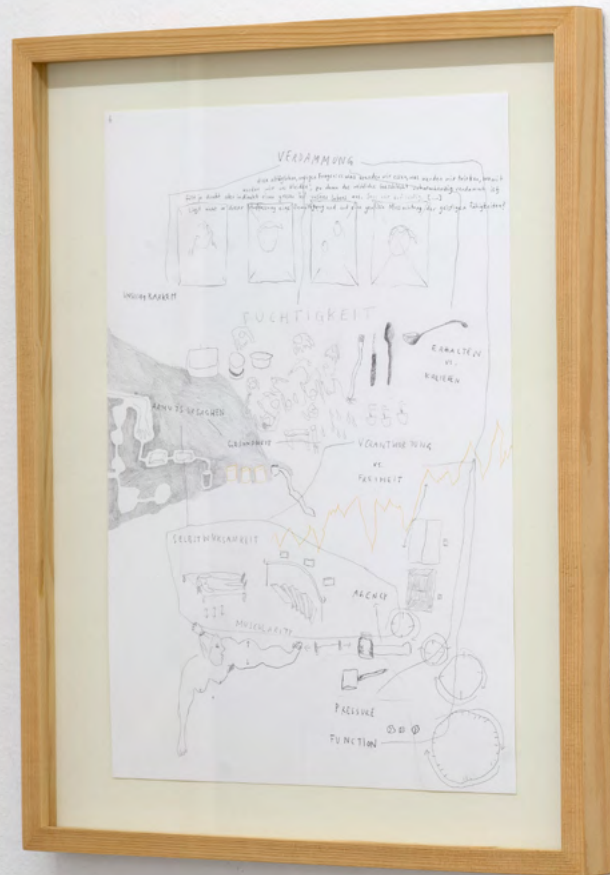
↑ Exhibition view: «Swiss Art Awards», Messe Art Basel, Photo: Gina Folly





↑ Exhibition view: «Rivages», Le Commun, Geneva, Photo: Kleio Obergfell-Thomaïdes





Amélie Moser-Moser

«Amélie Moser-Moser»
2025
series of 11 drawings
pencil on paper
29,7 x 42cm

• Kunsthau Langenthal «Im Haus der grossen Frau. Ein künstlerischer Blick auf die Sozialpionierin Amélie Moser-Moser», 2025

What does devotion mean? How can I take it into my own hands? What can friendship do? What do I want to possess, and for what? What does it mean to be able to decide what to share with whom? Why is competence necessary? How much do I want to drink? Is there unconditional solidarity? How do I become strong? What should we do

today? How can I be like her?

This project is a continuation of the use of critical fabulation after the «Ibu Silla» project: Through 11 drawings, 11 speculative question on the historical feminist and social pioneer Amélie Moser-Moser are being tackled, relating the historical to the personal and the present.



Warm fingers, moving

«Warm fingers, moving»
2025
Video
HD, without sound, loop
9:16, 32'34''
[Video Link \(Dropbox\)](#)

• Museum Bruder Klaus, Sachseln «Frieden – Мир», 2025

The overwhelming sensation of perceiving the hyperspeed and complexity of world events correlates with the rhythms of consuming social media. The eye jumps from war images to fashion ads, to snippets of daily life from friend groups, and then to political educational work.

„Warm fingers, moving“ merges and slows down these seemingly unrelated

contexts and thus makes potential connections graspable.



the center and the other

Iterations

- «the center and the other» (solo), Kunsthalle Luzern, 2023
- «the center and the other», Aeschlimann Corti Stipendium, Kunsthalle Bern, 2024
- «the center and the other» (solo), Kunsthalle Bern, 2024
- «hatchling pecks its echo chamber», annex14bis, Zollikofen, 2025
- «Latent, yet Operative», ARD art institution, Cairo, 2026



«the center and the other»
2023
chalk on wall
28 x 3,5 m

• Kunsthalle Luzern «the center and the other»,
2023

«How is intersectional feminism or the principle of property related to the difficulty of shopping seasonally?»

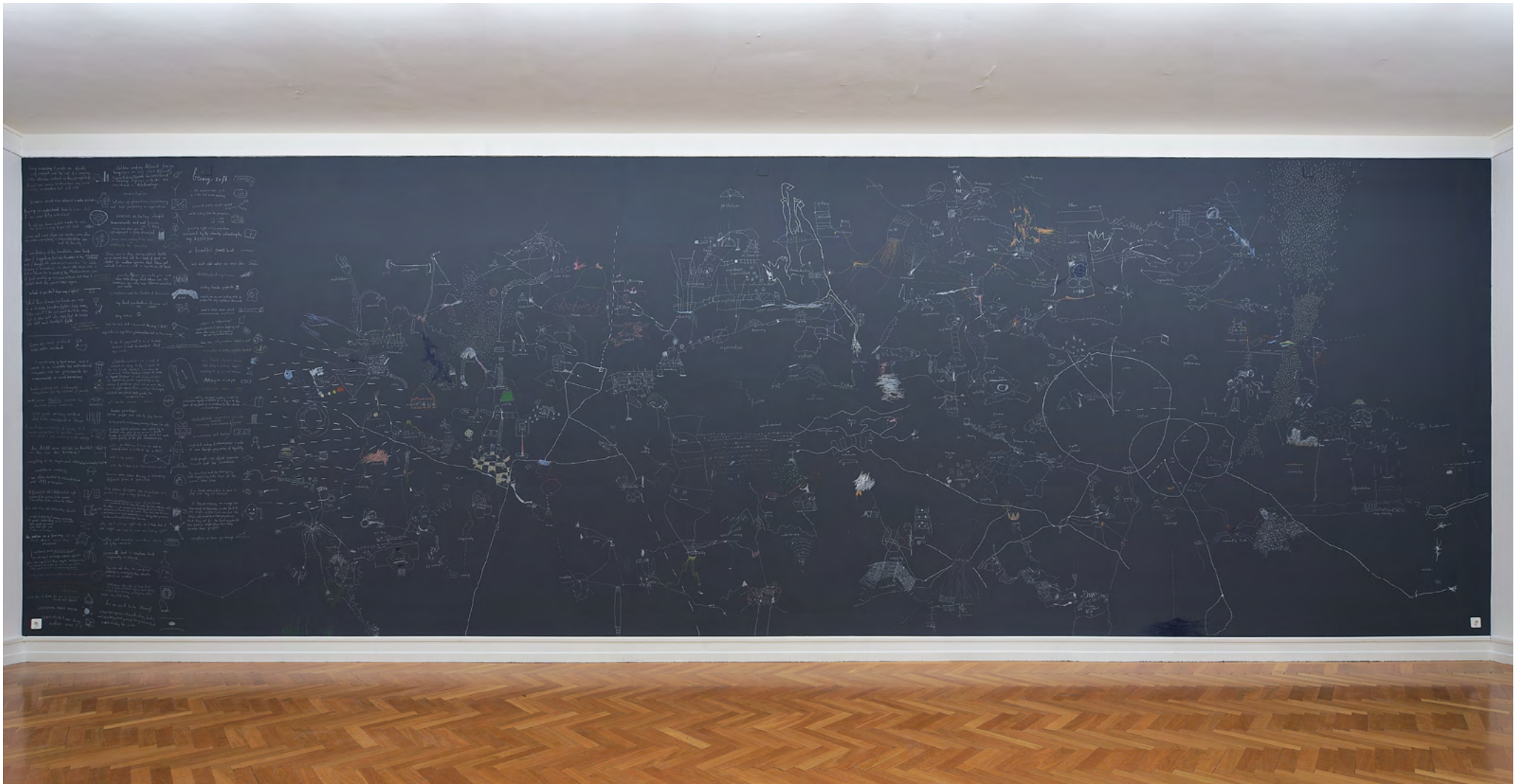
A subjective cartography of 28 meters makes connections: The wall drawing - dimensionally a quarter of a panoramic painting - includes an index of 120 terms, explanations, symbols, and questions that either concern or are of concern to

the artist. How are complex situations intertwined, and where am I in it – where do I position my subjectivity specifically? This section of a contemporary „horizon of thought“ presents itself as a very personal, exposed reflection of the artist's inner self. It is a performative piece about grasping the specificity of one's personal perspective among other's.

↑ Exhibition view: «the center and the other», Kunsthalle Luzern, Photo: Kilian Bannwart



↑ Exhibition view: «the center and the other», Kunsthalle Luzern, Photo: Kilian Bannwart



«the center and the other»
2024
chalk and pencil on wall
11 x 4,5 m

• Kunsthalle Bern «Aeschlimann Corti Stipendium»,
2024

The iteration of „the center and the other“ at Kunsthalle Bern begins on a flat, uncurved wall. It contains 280 additional abstract and concrete terms (like «companionship», «illness», «spaghetti») that constitute the «world» from the viewpoint of an exemplary subjectivity.



↑ Exhibition view: «Aeschlimann Corti Stipendium», Kunsthalle Bern, Photo: David Aepli



↑ Exhibition view: «the center and the other (title in progress)», Kunsthalle Bern, Photo: David Aebi

«(Facing shame) facing conflict»

«(Facing shame) facing conflict»

2024

Video

HD, stereo, loop

16:9, 18'56''

Guitar/Synthesizer: David Koch

Animation template: Brigade Brut

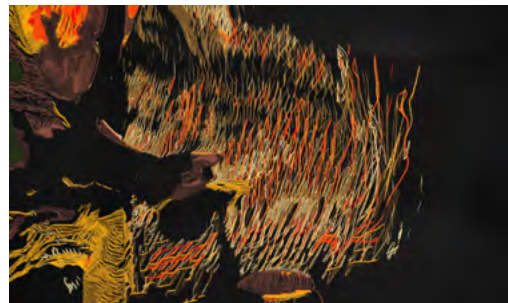
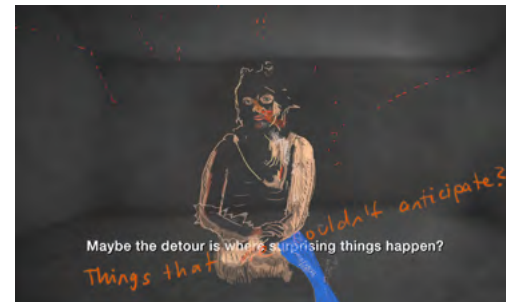
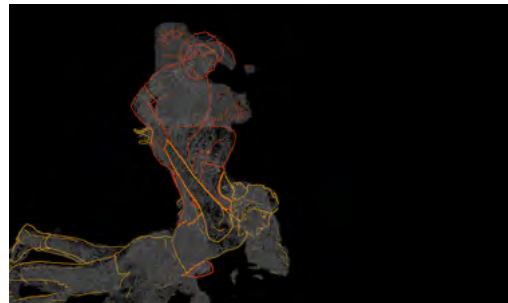
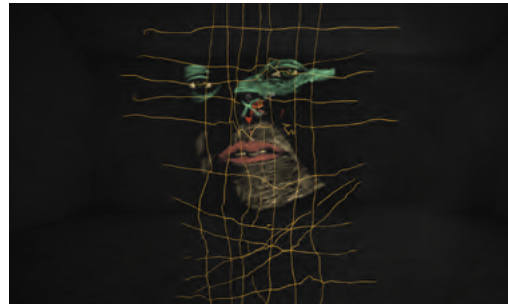
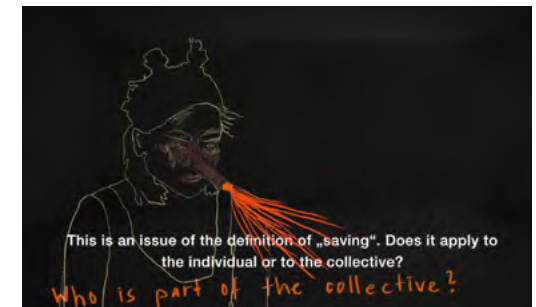
[Video Link \(vimeo\)](#)

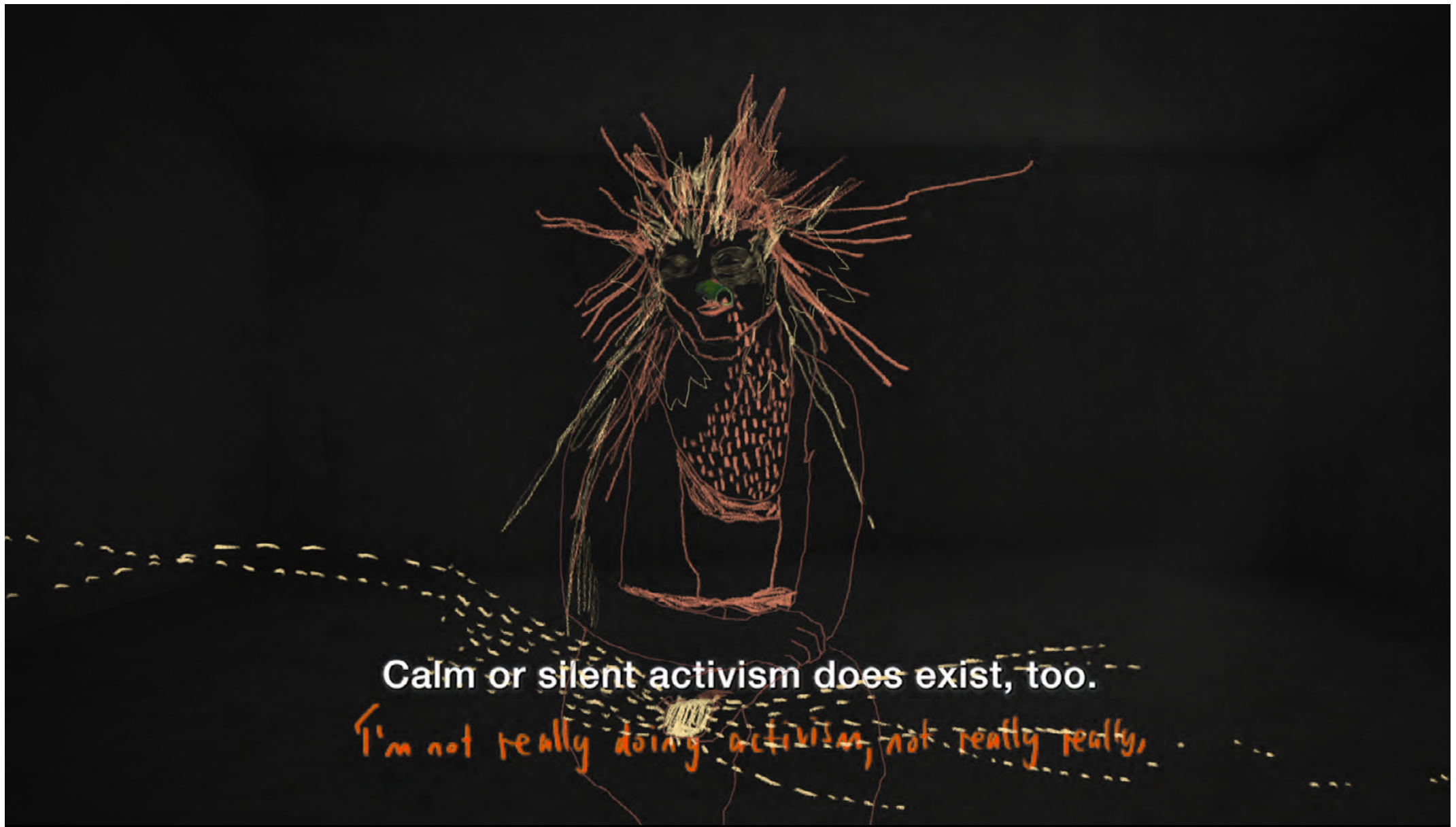
- b-05 «ECHOHALL IM BUNKER: history invades the present» Montabaur, GER, 2024
- Kunstmuseum Luzern «ZENTRAL!», 2024

«(Facing Shame) facing conflict», shown in a repurposed German bunker, addresses the constant failing attempts at personal positioning in the current political climate. What happens inside when the world outside is burning?

When personal logics are constructed and get caught in contradictions? When the actors in the conflicts are unclear? In this work, countless new, diffuse faces appear, similar to the ever-escalating contradictions in our reality. The work extends the concept of the «bunker» from the architectural to the psychological. In our minds, too, there are thick walls and mechanisms of isolation.

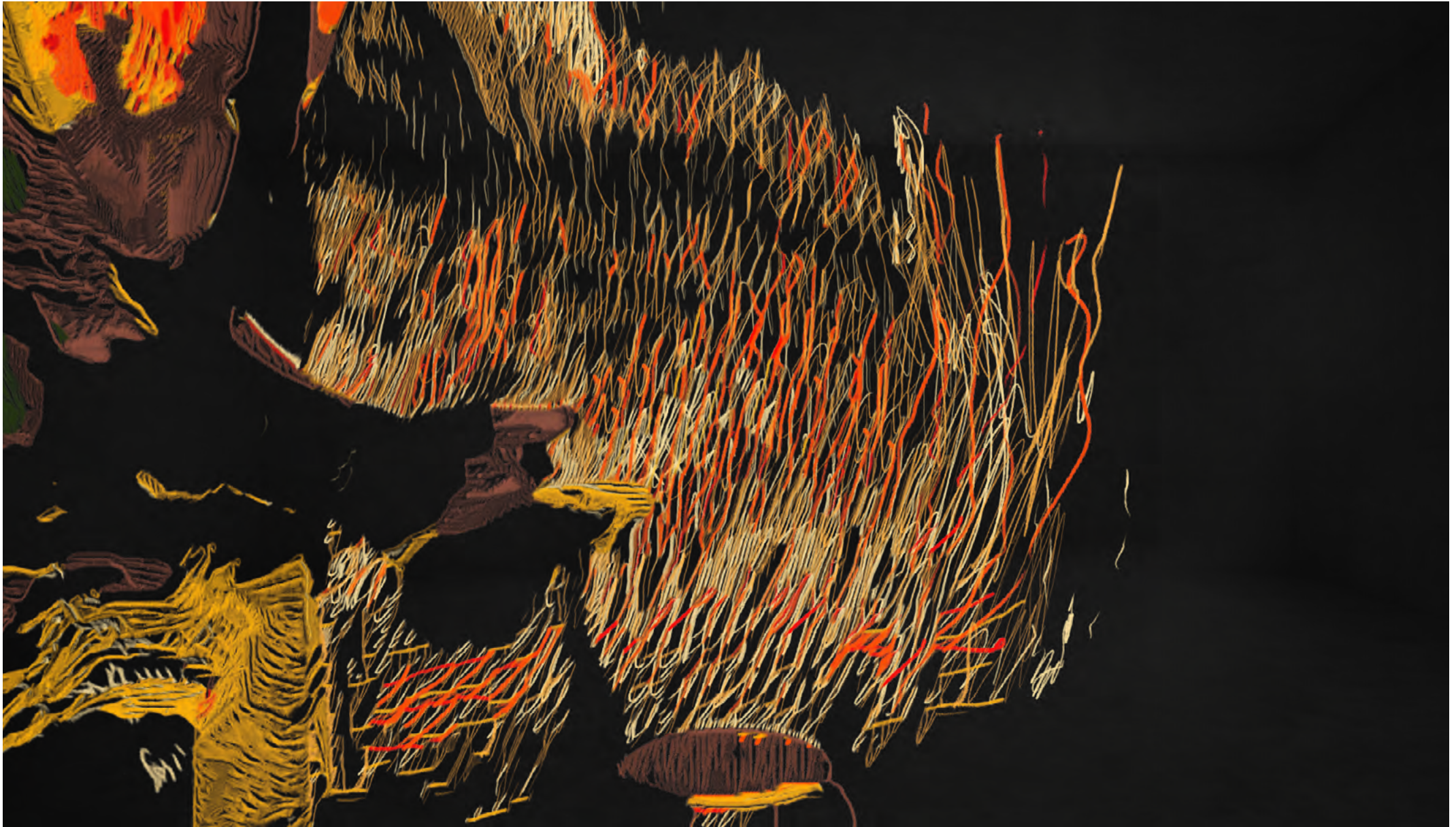
(Translated, original text: Till Langschied)





Calm or silent activism does exist, too.

I'm not really doing activism, not really really,





Everything series 1

«Everything series 1»

2024

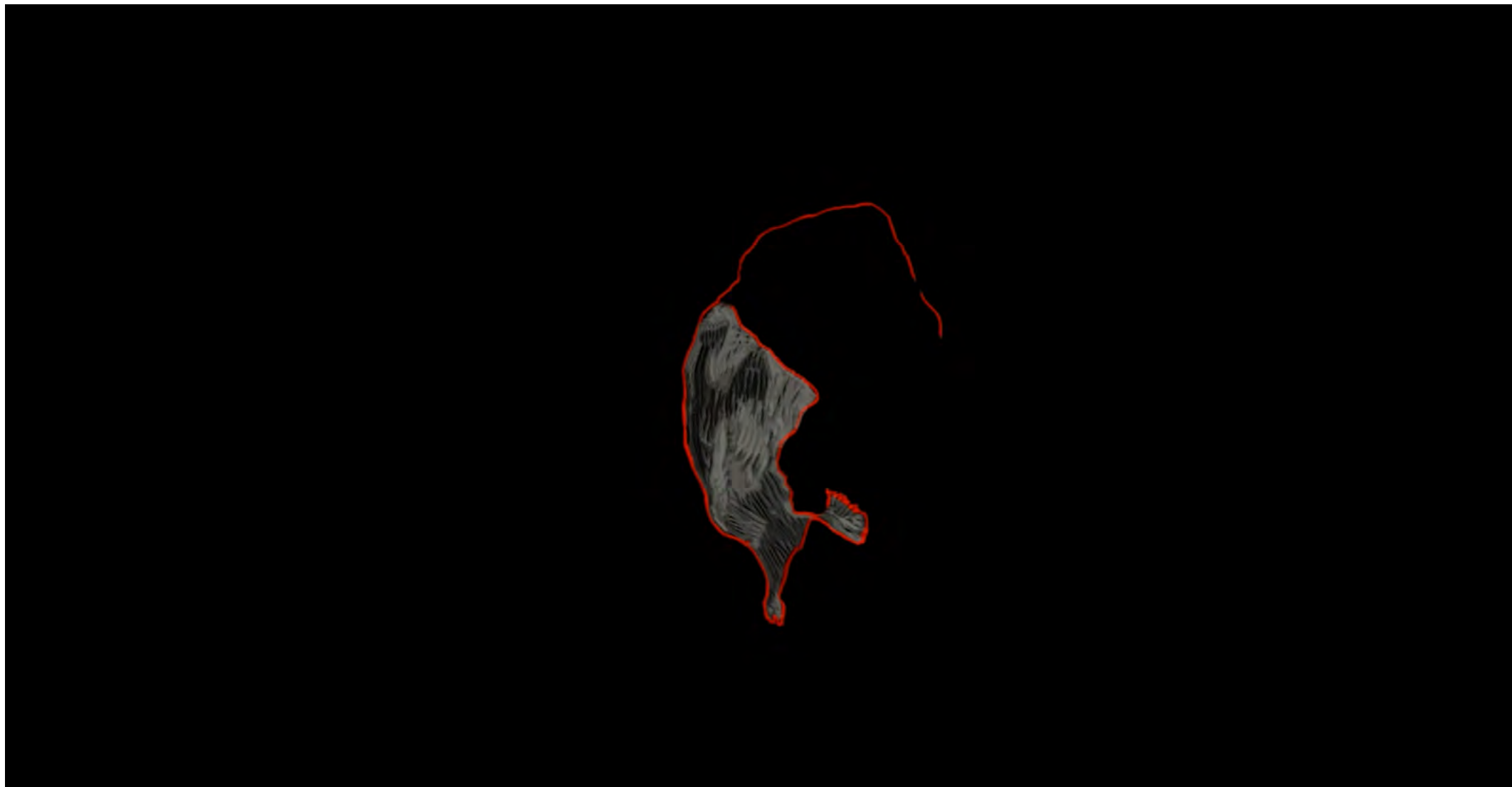
Interactive digital drawing
Soapstone, plasticine, joy-
stick and projection, pencil
[Link exemplary joystick move-
ment \(Video file, Dropbox\)](#)

«Everything series» deals with the
infinite endeavor to visually capture the
entirety of everything that exists. Part 1
is an initial digital drawing through
which, using a soapstone, one can
navigate infinitely in two dimensions
across all sides.

• Nidwaldner Museum, Stans «NOW 24», 2024



↑ Digital view (cropped section): «Everything series 1»



Running Lines

«Running Lines»

2023

Video

HD, no sound, loop, 16:9, 11'43''

[Video Link \(pCloud\)](#)

«Running Lines» is a video drawing in which a figure, traced in red, alternates between sprinting, stumbling, and dissolving into a wave. The work speaks of a moment of affective overload: the urge to flee, the collapse into fragmentation, and the uncertain return to form. The figure's repeated dissolution and reappearance echoes the cyclical attempt to regain footing in an unknown (black/

opaque) and unstable environment.



sketches on loving a family

«sketches on loving a family»
2023

Video

HD, stereo, loop, 16:9, 16'35''

Soundscape: Till Hillbrecht

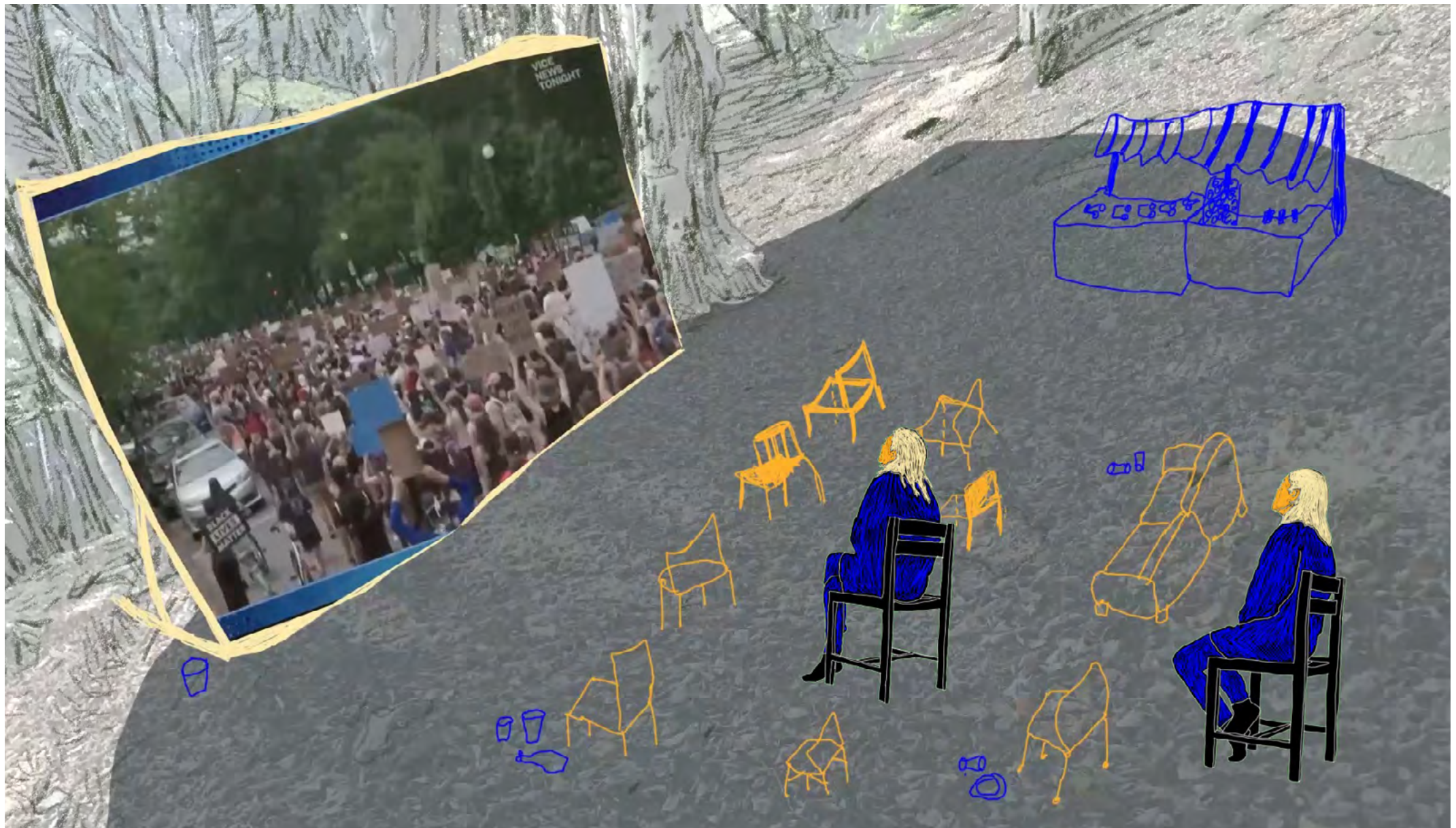
[Video Link \(Dropbox\)](#)

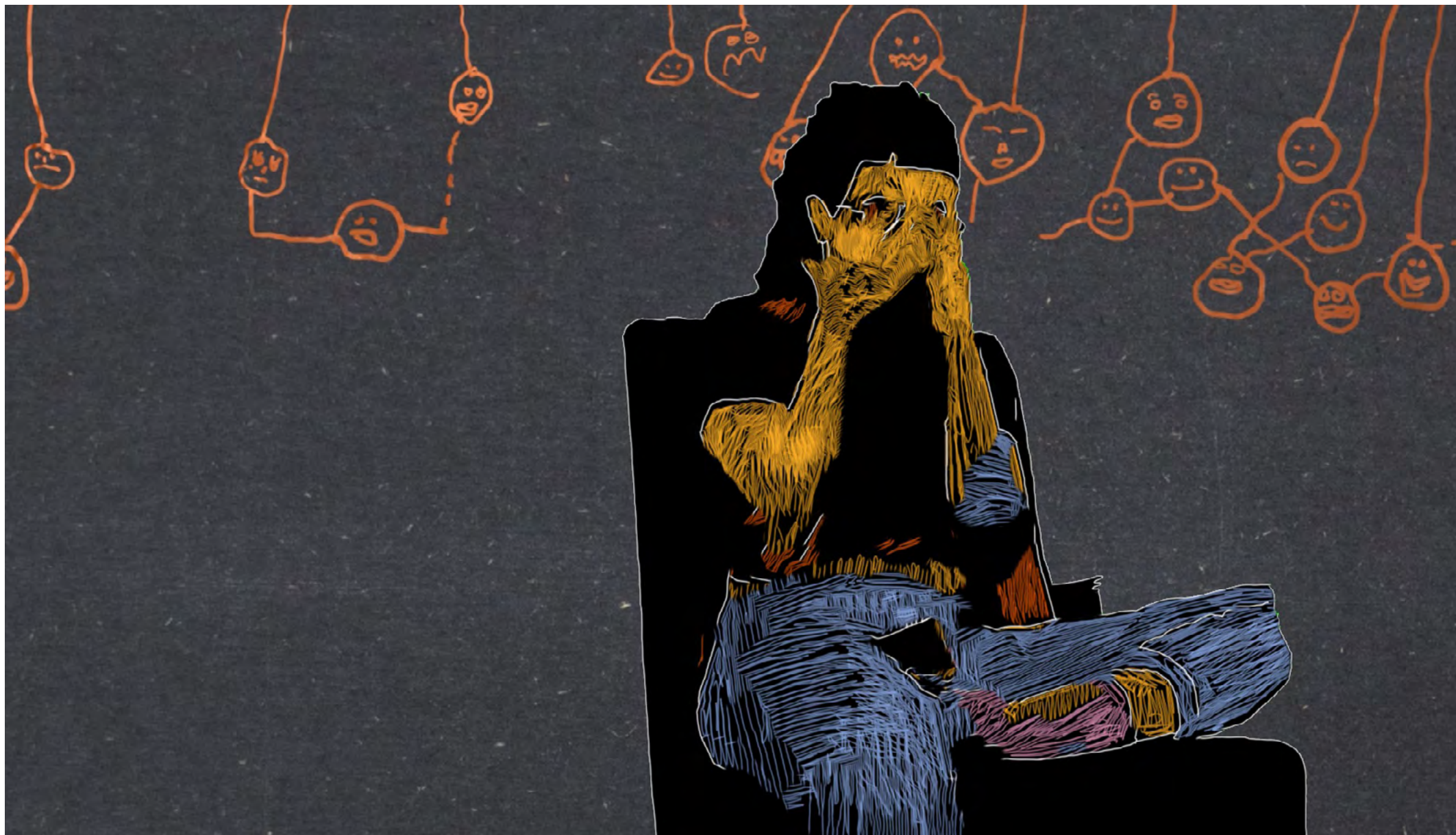
- Kunsthalle Luzern «the center and the other», 2023
- Kunstmuseum Thun «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2023
- Prozess, Bern «on loving a family», 2024

How to deal with political differences or vast ideological gaps within families, how to manage emotional tensions and your own borders of acceptance?

«Sketches on loving a family» contains interviews with 5 people of a diversity of familial, ethnical, class and national backgrounds (Brazil, USA/Germany, Argentina, Lebanon and Switzerland)

who talk about their relationships with politically clashing family members whom they still love in different ways. The video starts with a scene of the US «Daily Show» on political polarizations that is shown in an animated forest cinema. Then, the interviewed persons appear as animated characters that slowly and increasingly become deformed and distorted - visually «torn apart».





Dear grandfather (grandfather's face)

«Dear grandfather (grandfather's face)»

2021

Video

HD, stereo, loop

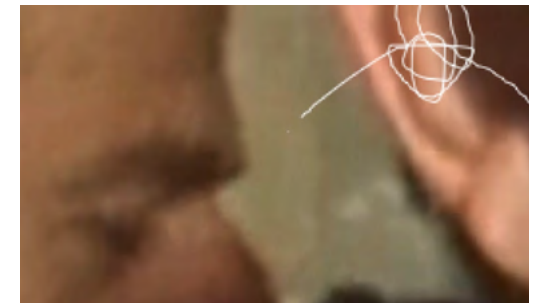
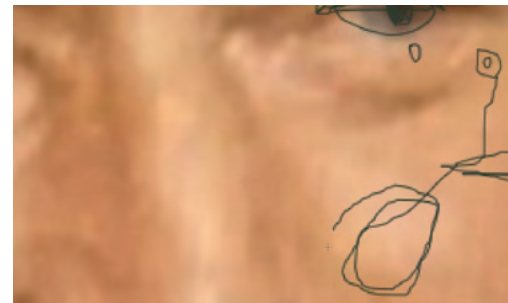
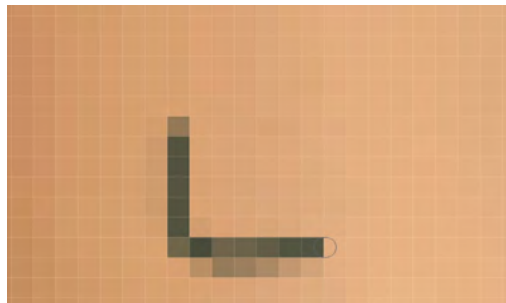
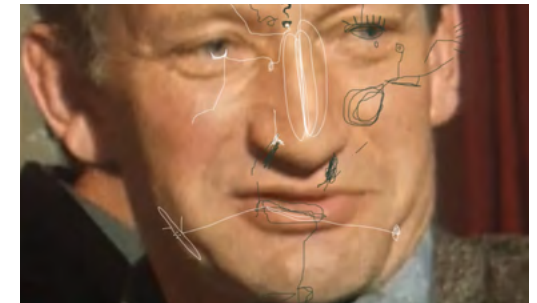
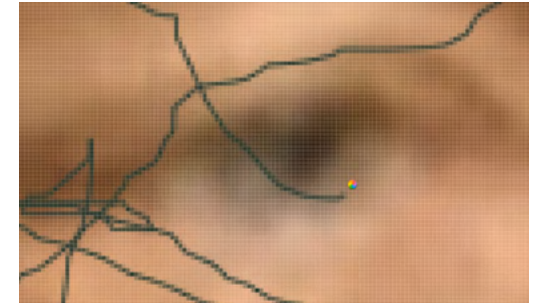
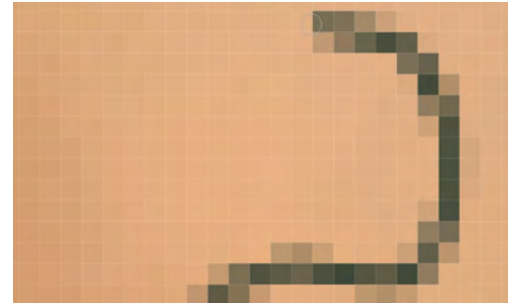
16:9, 03'07''

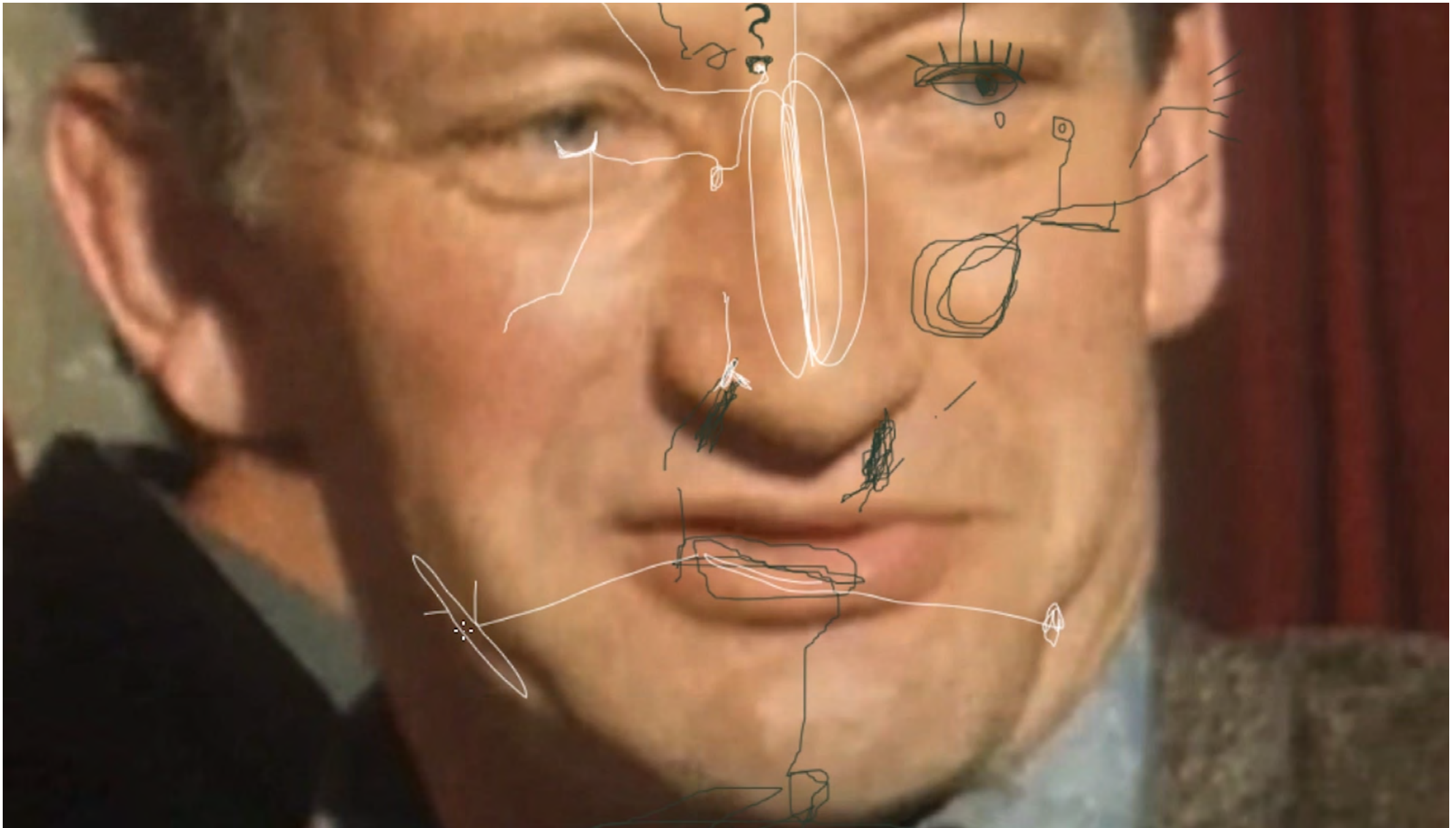
[Video Link \(Dropbox\)](#)

- Kunstmuseum Luzern «ZENTRAL!», 2022
- EAC (les halles) «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2022
- CAN Centre d'art Neuchâtel «Video Show & The Blind Pigeon», 2022
- Videokunst.ch: Showroom PROGR, Bern / Houdini Kino, Zürich / Klibühni, Chur, 2022
- Cité Screenings, Cité internationale des Arts, Paris, 2022

«Of course I'm against it, too» – In 1975, the artist's grandfather has been stating his opinion on the women's right to vote on Swiss national tv.

How to deal with contradictory feelings towards beloved family members with whom one dissents fundamentally about basic worldviews? Writings and drawings are directly being marked on the footage, on the grandfather's face, onto the surface of the very moment of his «painful» statements. Thereby, the core question processually shifts from „How to relate?“ towards: „How to deal with non-relating?“





«Ibu Silla»

Iterations:

- «Ibu Silla» (Video), 2022
- «Ibu Silla» (Book), 2024
- «this is my landscape, this is my landscape for you» (VR video installation), 2021

«Ibu Silla»

2019-2021

Video

HD, stereo, loop

16:9, 48'40''

[Video Link \(Dropbox\)](#)

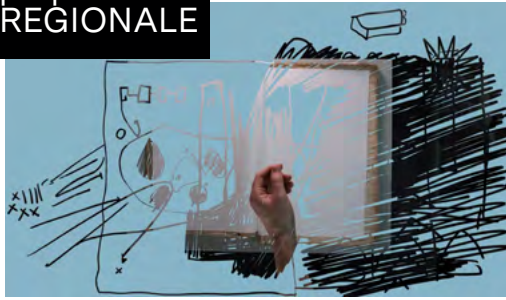
- Galerie Hofmatt, Sarnen «Ibu Silla», 2021
- Kunstmuseum Thun, «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2022

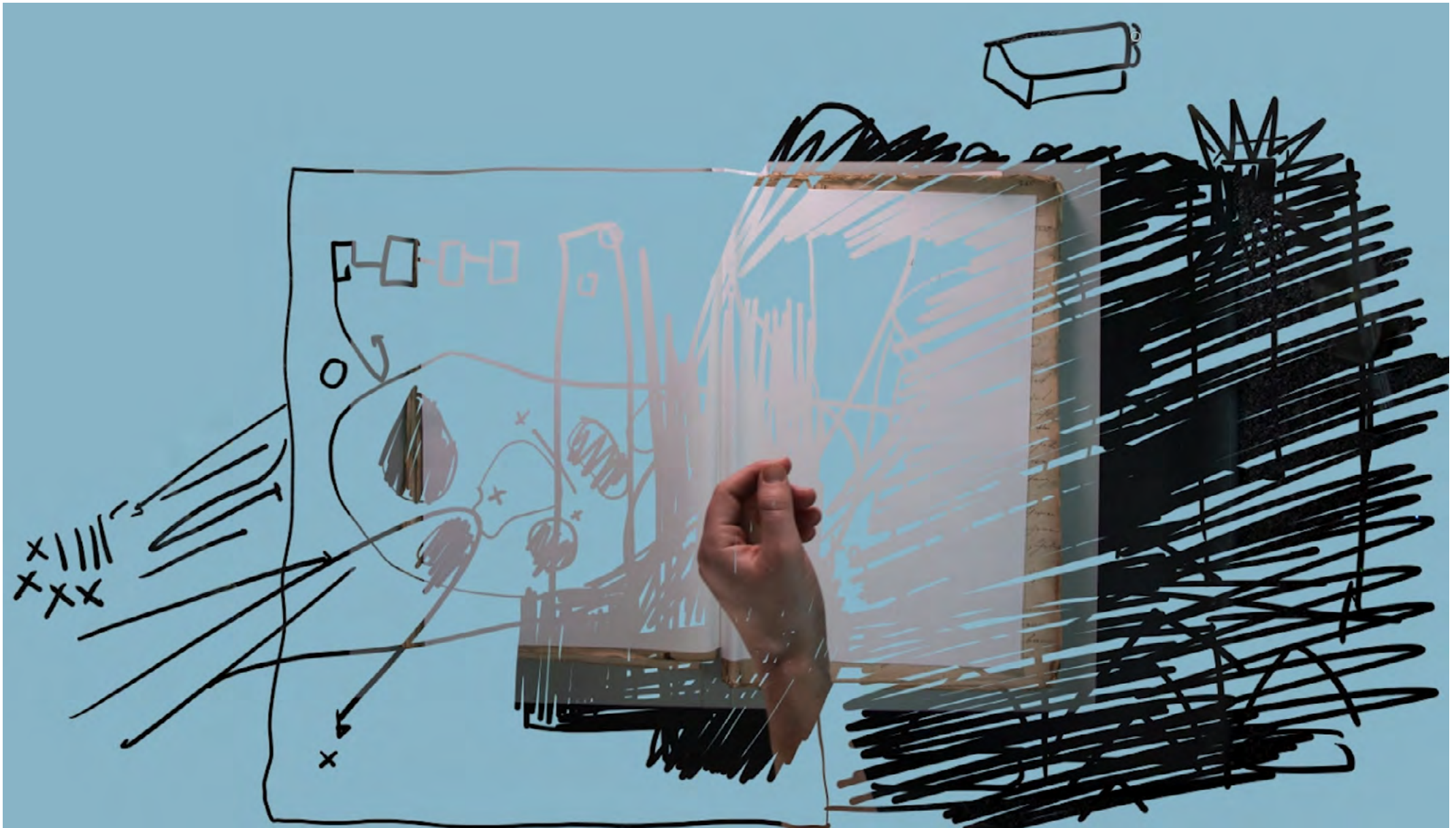
The State Archive of Nidwalden holds 15 boxes of diaries belonging to the mercenary Alois Wyrsh («Borneo Louis»). From 1816, Wyrsh was stationed in Borneo (Banjarmasin) under Dutch colonial rule and returned to Nidwalden in 1832 with two of his children, whom he had with an Indigenous woman. This woman, referred to in the documents as Johanna, Ibu Silla, or Belle, was left behind along with another child. In the diaries, the passages where he writes about her have been meticulously cut out. The reasons for this remain speculative.

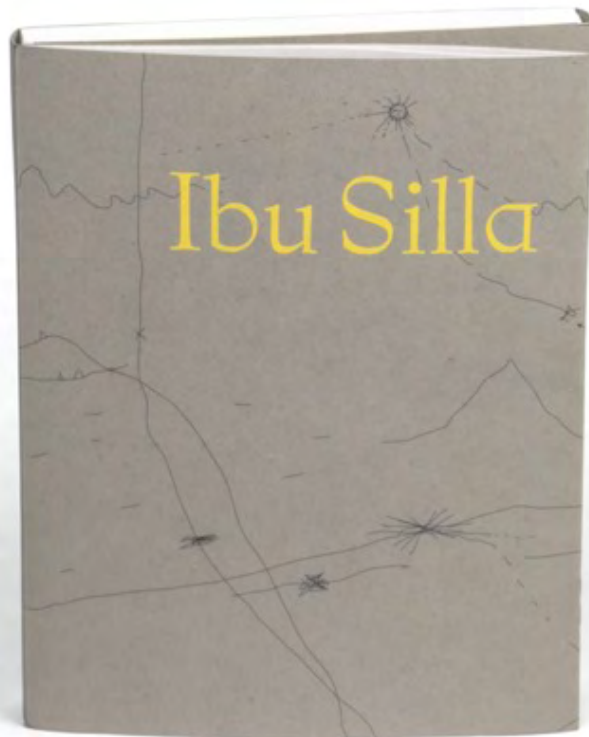
In 14 chapters, this video work now speculates on realistic to abstract biographies. The subtractive drawing process resembles the scraping away of a layer, uncovering documentary imagery and formally referencing the cut-out gaps.

The open questions about Ibu Silla unfold possibilities for multiple biographies. The methodology of this work proposes a way to engage with male-white-dominated historiography: allowing «counter-narratives» or «para-stories» to emerge in the «mental archives» thereby fostering a multiplicity of perspectives.

proposed for
REGIONALE







«Ibu Silla»
2024
Book project
edition fink, Contemporary Art
publishers

The book project consists of the fictional
text on the speculative biography of Ibu
Silla, an explanatory essay, and a fold-
out drawn map.

Short documentary on real lesbianism

«short documentary on real lesbianism»

2021

Video

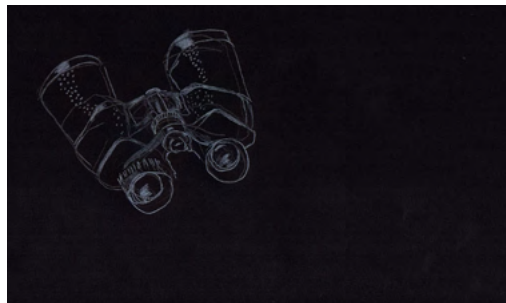
HD, stereo loop

16:9, 01'52''

[Trailer Link \(vimeo\)](#)

Password: lesbian

The fictional documentary takes place in the core forest, a dense forest near the village where the artist grew up; a village where the artist experienced her lesbian identity as abnormal during her teenage years, and where the secret, intimate wish arose to live in a society made up only of lesbians. This narrative centers around the absurd fiction of a ‚Swiss indigenous people‘ consisting solely of lesbians. However, this essentialist fantasy of purity and equality within a society could dangerously resemble nationalist or racist images of the ‚purity‘ of peoples; an issue that is part of this exploration.





neutral background

Iterations

- «notational system on neutral background» (video installation), 2017 - 2021
- «neutral background» (print on wallpaper), 2020
- «credit of about 420 billion Swiss francs (...)» (laser-cut on paper), 2021



← Exhibition view: «NOW 21», Nidwaldner Museum, Photo: Christian Hartmann

«notational system on neutral background»
 2017 - 2021
 2-channel video installation / video
 HD, stereo, loop
 16:9, 56'59" / 10'44"
[Video Link \(long version: Dropbox, 2 files\)](#)
[Video Link \(short version\)](#)

- Sommerakademie Paul Klee, Online-Publikation «STATECRAFT», 2020 (kurze Version)
- E-Werk Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, Freiburg i. Br., GER «Material Worlds», 2021
- Centre d'Art Pasquart «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2021
- Nidwaldner Museum «NOW 21», 2021
- Kunsthau Langenthal «Aeschlimann Corti Stipendium», 2022

«Notational System on Neutral Background» evolves from expanded ongoing research on problematic entanglements of Swiss economic policies. Swiss mythologies and self-identifications of neutrality and innocence still (partly) persist when it comes to discussions of colonial histories and racism. Strong economic involvements, be it in the transatlantic slave trade, or, more recent-

ly, human rights violations on behalf of global corporations, have been overlooked. This research focuses on such global involvements, and asks how Swiss policymaking is involved. [...]»
 (Text: Tirdad Zolghadr)



↑ Exhibition view: «NOW 21», Nidwaldner Museum, Photo: Christian Hartmann

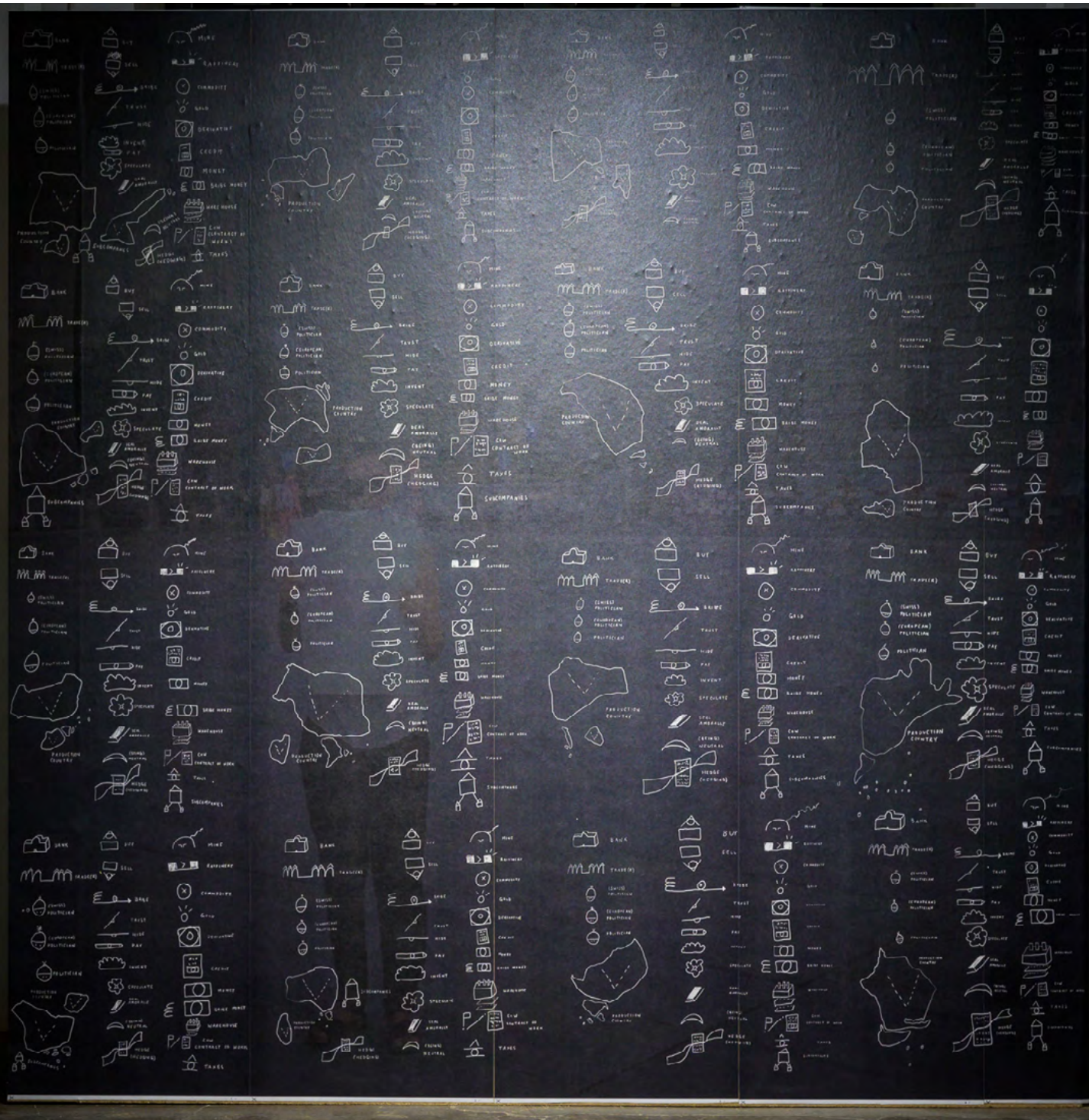


«neutral background»
2020
digital print on wallpaper
series, 3 parts
size mutable

- E-Werk Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, Freiburg i. Br., GER «Material Worlds» 2021
- Kunsthalle Basel «...von möglichen Welten» 2021
- Kunstmuseum Luzern «ZENTRAL!» 2020

The wallpaper series showcases the development of the visual vocabulary that makes the complex facts of economic policy more visually accessible. It highlights problematic entanglements in terms of their structural form and deep-rooted embedding within the system. The recurring forms of power structures in the trajectories of colonial and post-colonial relationships become

motifs for a reproducible and shareable product: a series of wallpapers, with the drawings / maps / network structures forming their pattern. The patterns use a unified vocabulary of symbols and shapes but are not directly repetitive as is typically the case with wallpaper. Instead, the wallpapers display the process of understanding: the development of the notation system.



↑ Exhibition view: «Material Worlds – Storied Matter», E-Werk, Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, 2021, Photo: Marc Doradzillo

credit (...)

«credit of about 420 billion Swiss francs (...)

2021

12 lasercuts on paper, LED strips, framed
20 x 20 cm

- E-Werk Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, Freiburg i. Br., GER «Material Worlds» 2021
- Kunsthaus Langenthal «Aeschlimann Corti Stipendium» 2022

Laser-cut paper silhouettes of twelve morally problematic events in Swiss economic history are backlit with LEDs.

credit of about 420 billion swiss francs from schweizerische kreditanstalt to fascist „junta“ dictatorship (known for the murder of at least 30'000 people). / switzerland was not part of the UNO up to 2002 (because of „neutrality“), which led to the possibility of swiss based companies to not follow the UNO's resolutions or embargoes. / involvement of ticinese politicians with transfer of trucks full of (hush money) lira from lombardia over the border to switzerland. / tax privileges for holdings and domicile companies (much lower rates, and gains from sharings from other companies can be deducted from the taxable income), and still 28% of the swiss tax revenues from corporations come from profits made elsewhere and being channeled into switzerland. / fictional daughter companies: coffee trading company volcafe avoided paying taxes for profits of 24 million dollars in one year by the creation of a completely fictional company called cofina that didn't have even one employee. / a proposed law (by swiss council susanne leutenegger oberholzer, SP/BL) for more transparency in commodity trade, more precisely for the publications of turnover, profit and tax amounts in each country, was voted against by both chambers of the swiss council and the federal assembly. / political support (and double roles) for offshore (“letterbox”) companies. for example: adriano imfeld was a national council from 2001 to 2007. He was at the same time running a trust company and holding on trust a couple of daughter companies of “norilsk”, a nickel giant. / influence of speculation on volatility of commodity prices: the practice of hedging, which is betting on rising or falling commodity prices, is most likely destabilizing markets (blurry lines between stock market activities for the sake of speculation, or for hedging, which is part of the trading business and a method of risk minimization) and leads to hunger. / supply chains, contracts of works, blurring legal responsibilities: A practice of complex and intransparent interlacing of holding companies. corporations divide into dozens of associated companies or „subcompanies“ in different countries, in order to distribute costs and profits the way that taxes can be minimized as much as possible (22 different subcompanies of glencore only in the state of delaware in the year 2011). / profit of swiss commodity trade companies from deals with sensitive or conflicting areas, corrupted governments, dictatorships or war zones. / in chile, when the mining company disputada de las condes was sold by the exxon corporation in 2002, it became clear: even though the company never paid any taxes to chile, never made any profit, but instead was doing heavy financial losses every consecutive year since 22(!) years, because they were so indebted towards their associated company in bermudas, it was sold for 2,3 billion dollars. / today, a globalized elite chooses their nationality and the train stations for their capital (a newer practice is to hoard valuables in tax free zones), whilst societal redistribution mechanism are still bound to the nation state.





↑ Exhibition view: «Material Worlds – Storied Matter», E-Werk, Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, 2021, Photo: Marc Doradzillo



↑ Exhibition view: «Material Worlds – Storied Matter», E-Werk, Galerie für Gegenwartskunst, 2021, Photo: Marc Doradzillo



We have found traces of a people that lived without any gravity.

How Do Stones Grow?

«How Do Stones Grow?»

2018, video

HD, stereo, loop

16:9, 13'43''

[Trailer Link \(vimeo\)](#)

- Stadtgalerie Bern, «Cantonale Berne Jura», 2019
- Nidwaldner Museum, «in cavo: where all the aims cross», 2018
- Baehndlistrasse 86, «Wesen», 2024

The study and staging of the «Other» was often used during the Enlightenment to construct a contrast in order to present and define one's own culture as superior. Olivia Abächerli addresses this in her video «How do stones grow?» by impersonating an anthropologist who discovered a previously unknown past society: beings that move, communicate, and live differently, exposing our way of

existence as just one of many possibilities. (Translation, original text: Karen Amanda Moser)



If they are a map

Iterations

- «If they are a map» (mural), 2019
- «If they are a map» (mural), 2019
- «I saw convex equatorial deserts and each one of their grains of sand» (mixed media on canvas), 2022



«if they are a map»
2019
oil pastels on wall
2,2 x 2,2 m

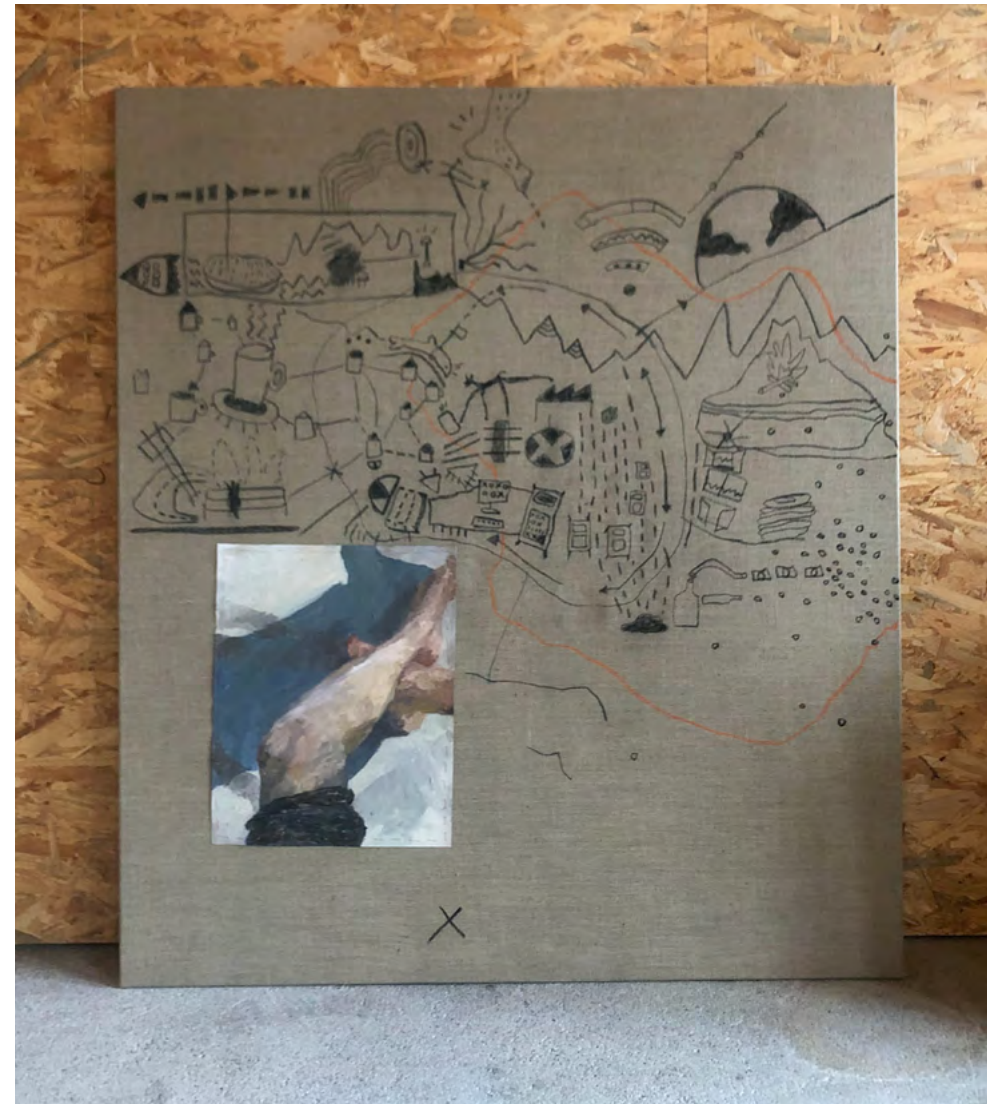
- Grand Palais, Bern «Les Environs (le voisin et son stupide chien)», 2019
- Hot Wheels Projects, Athens, GRC «How it comes to matter», 2018

«If they are a map» is a drawn investigation into how we can orient ourselves, locate ourselves, and contextualize in the complex present. How does anyone orient themselves in a multitude of parameters of time, space, and social contexts? In the large-format drawings, this question is addressed by layering a multitude of subjective cartographies – a variety of perspectives.



«I saw convex equatorial
deserts and each one of their
grains of sand»
2022
Mixed media on canvas
each 160 x 140 cm

• Espace libre, Biel «global earth powder trace»,
2022



↑ Studio shots: «I saw convex equatorial deserts and each one of their grains of sand»

Companionship Euphoria

«Companionship Euphoria»
collective: Isabella Beneduci
(artist, social anthropologist
and activist from Brasil),
Line Rime (Illustrator and
feminist activist from Fri-
bourg) and Olivia Abächerli.

Projects:

- Reading group «Unlearning Imperialism», Cité internationale des Arts, Paris, 2022 - 2023
- «You are not here with me in the kitchen right now» (Exhibition project), 2023
- «Companionship Euphoria Letter Reading» (Performance), 2024
- «Companionship Euphoria», (Research project on political agency through feminist friendship), 2024 - ongoing



↑ Exhibition view: «You are not here with me (...)», Galerie Duflon Racz Projekt LINKS, Photo: Line Rime

«You are not here with me in the kitchen right now, but I wish you were»

2023

Mixed Media on wall,
Print on carpet

Audio

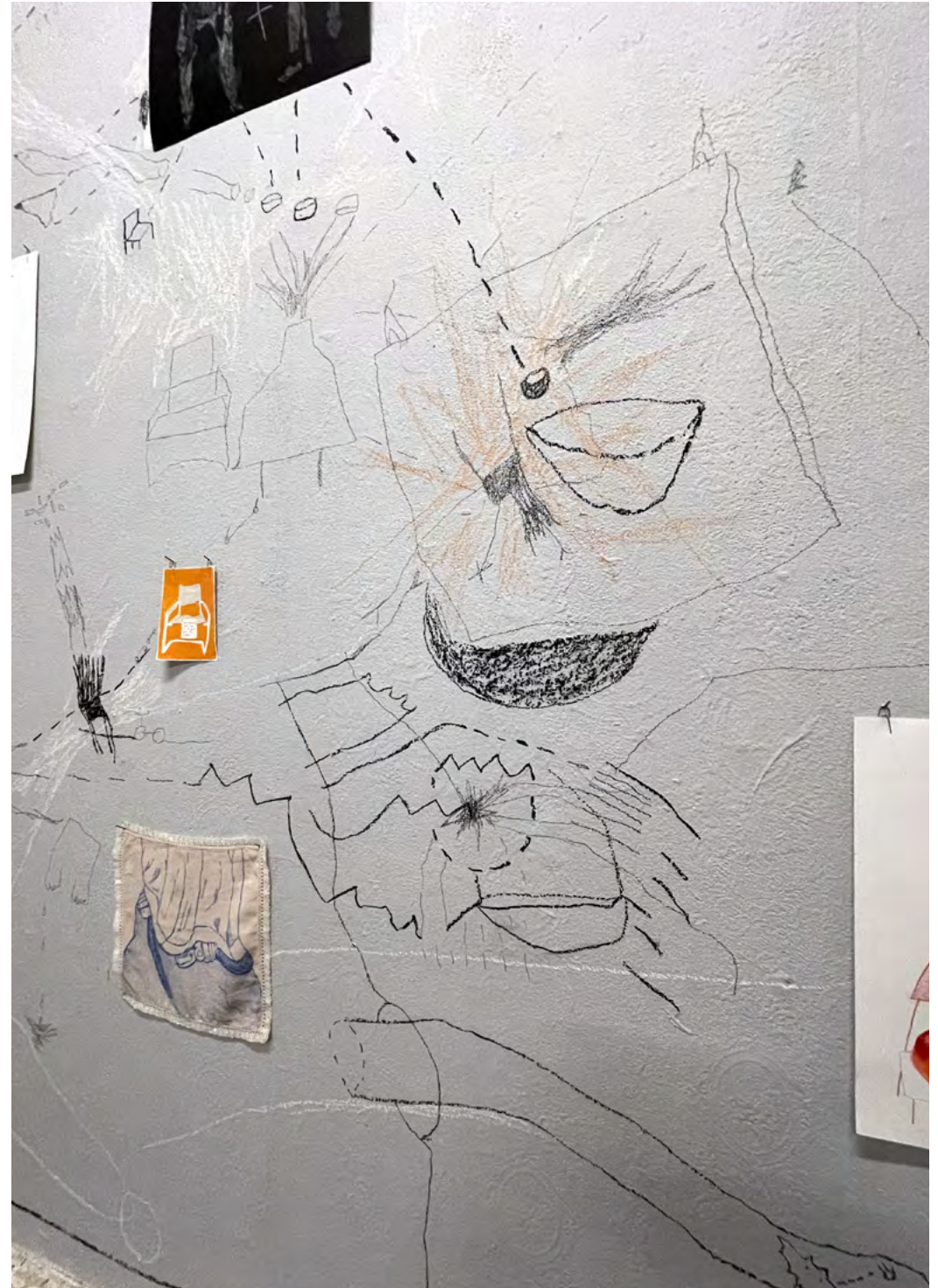
WAC, stereo, 26'58''

[Audio Link \(Google Drive\)](#)

• Galerie Duflon Racz Projekt LINKS, Bern «You are not here with me in the kitchen right now, but I wish you were», 2023

Through letters and exchanged drawings, the collective engages in dialogue with the respective political contexts – and how these influence personal lives. In a group exhibition, some of the drawings were displayed, while the letters – the connections – were translated into a wall drawing by Olivia Abächerli. A carpet with a photo (by Isabella Beneducci) depicting Olivia shaving Line's hair

formed the centerpiece of the space, where it was possible to listen to spoken passages from the letters.



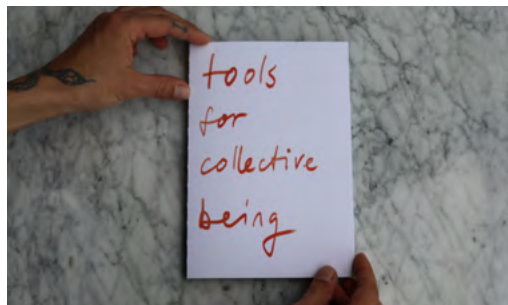
↑ Exhibition views: «You are not here with me in the kitchen right now, but I wish you were», Galerie Duflon Raczy Projekt LINKS, Photos: Line Rime



↑ Exhibition views: «You are not here with me in the kitchen right now, but I wish you were», Galerie Duflon Racz Projekt LINKS, Photo: Line Rime



tools for collective being



«tools for collective being»
2025
Publication by Ēgle Šalkauskyte
& Olivia Abächerli
116 pages
published by «unvague»

• Prozess, Bern «Book Launch» 2025



What would a box full of tools to help us practice active listening look like? The radio show Jelly Sunday gave rise to a digital zine that is published as a book - using many voices in the form of text, photography, painting and collage.

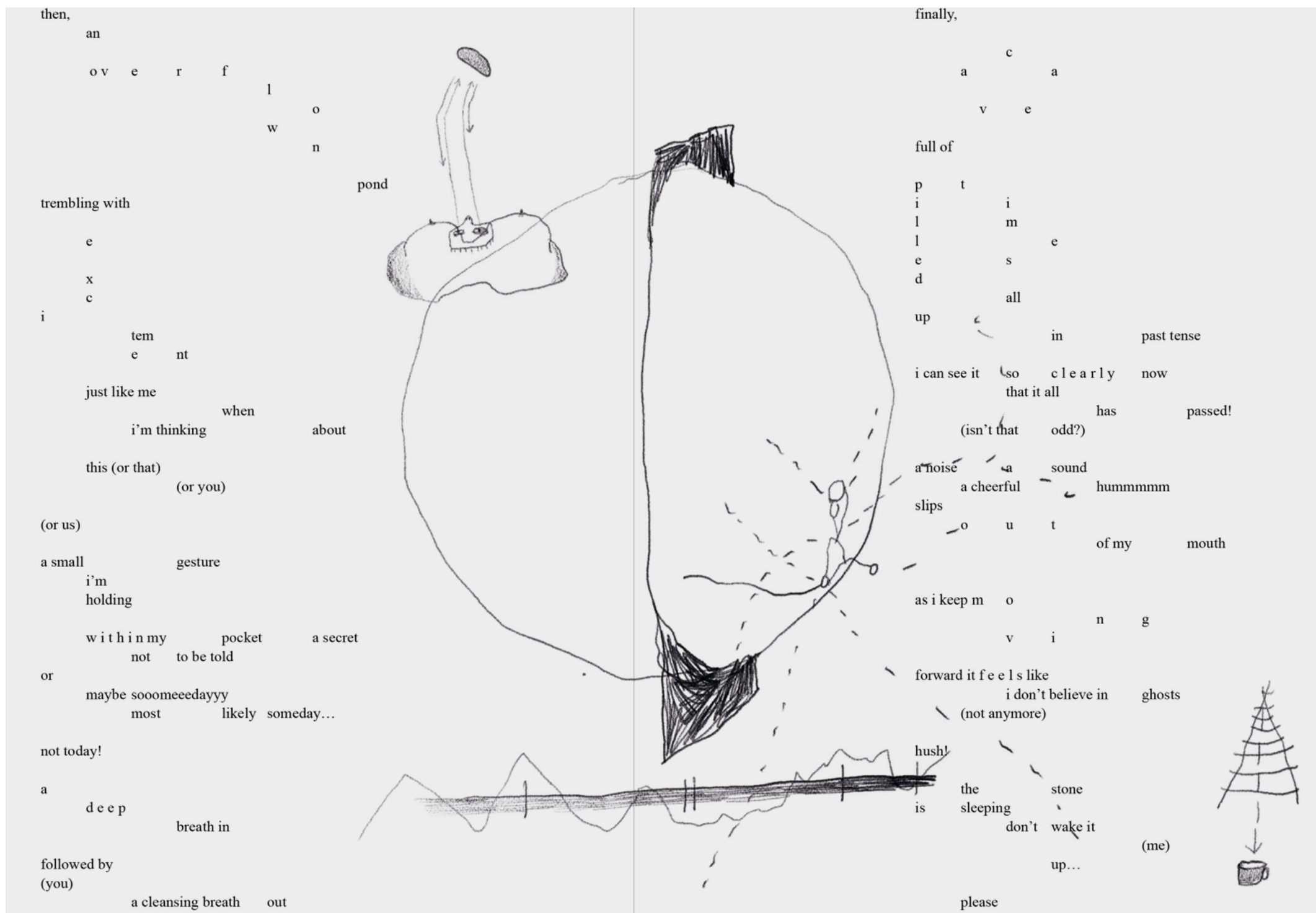


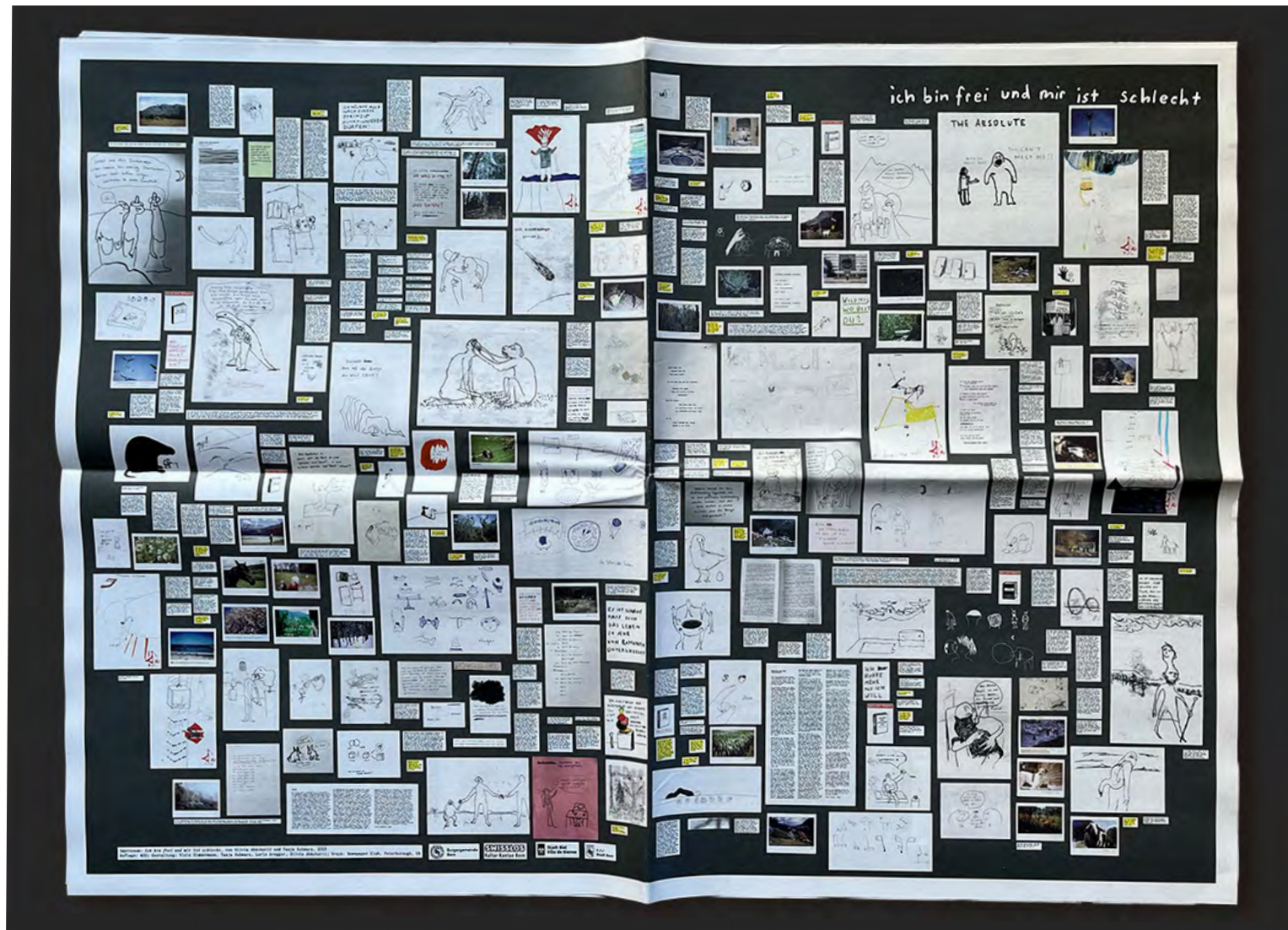


Jelly Sunday
Zine

«Jelly Sunday Zine»
2023 -
digital Zine, released monthly
[Link \(Bandcamp\)](#)

Collective with:
Égle Šalkauskyte, Saskia
Winkelmann, Jasmin Christen,
Juliette Henrioud, Olivia
Abächerli





ich bin frei und
mir ist schlecht

«ich bin frei und mir ist
schlecht»

2023

Publication by Tanja Schwarz &
Olivia Abächerli

35 x 50 cm

24 pages

- Kunsthaus Interlaken «10+10+1», 2023
- Kunsthalle Bern «Cantonale Bern Jura», 2023

- - - - - Material flows

Iterations

- «- - - - - Material flows» (installation), 2022
- «Where do I shoot my arrow», (performance), 2018



«- - - - - Material flows»
2022
chalk and coal on 4 stone
plates
each 1 x 2 m
Multiple: Offset print
78 x 63 cm

What does it mean to own land? What responsibilities or privileges are associated with it? Common lands or corporations («Commons») are historical models for communal property and land management, often of mountains, forests, or water. From the exploration of the meaning of land, territorial, and (agricultural) resource ownership, a visual vocabulary

emerged. Territories, paths, and trails were left as traces of chalk and coal on four local stone slabs. The accompanying map provides insight into the research and serves as an index for the visual vocabulary.

• Turbine Giswil «Kulturlandschaft Obwalden»,
2022



↑ Exhibition view: «Kulturlandschaft Obwalden» Turbine Giswil



↑ Exhibition view: «Kulturlandschaft Obwalden» Turbine Giswil

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